

BASELINE STUDY REPORT
ON
SAFER FUTURES PROJECT (WATOTO WETU PHASE IV)

PREPARED FOR



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“Powering Progress Through Knowledge”

DATE OF SUBMISSION:
September 2026

TABLE OF CONTENTS

TABLE OF CONTENTS	2
LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS	4
ACKNOWLEDGEMENT	6
EXECUTIVE SUMMARY	7
1.0 INTRODUCTION	9
1.1 Project Background	9
1.2 Project Goal	10
1.3 Project Outcomes	11
1.4 Purpose of the Baseline Study	12
1.5 Objectives of the Baseline Study	12
1.6 Scope of the baseline study	13
2.0 BASELINE METHODOLOGY AND APPROACH	14
2.1 Methodology	14
2.2 Baseline Study Limitations	15
3.0 BASELINE STUDY FINDINGS	17
3.1 Baseline Status of Child Protection, Child Participation, SRHR, Peacebuilding, Environmental Resilience, and Institutional Capacity	17
3.1.1 Status of child protection systems	17
3.1.2 Status of children's Participation	19
3.1.3 Status of Harmful practices	21
3.1.4 Status of SRHR	23
3.1.5 Status of Peace Building	25
3.1.6 Status of environmental resilience	26
3.1.7 organizational capacity before project implementation	28
3.2 Knowledge, Attitudes, Behaviours, and Capacities of Rights Holders and Duty Bearers	30
3.2.1 Knowledge, Attitudes, Behaviours, and Capacities of Rights Holders	31
3.2.2 Knowledge, Attitudes, Behaviours, and Capacities of Duty Bearers	32
3.3 Functionality and Effectiveness of Child Protection, SRHR, Peacebuilding, Environmental Governance, and Referral Systems	34
3.3.1 Functionality and Effectiveness of Child Protection	35
3.3.2 Functionality and Effectiveness of SRHR	36

3.3.3 Functionality and Effectiveness of Peacebuilding	38
3.3.4 Functionality and Effectiveness of Environmental Governance	39
3.3.5 Functionality and Effectiveness of Referral Systems	41
3.4 Enabling and Constraining Factors Influencing the Realization of Children's Rights	43
3.4.1 Enabling factors influencing realization of children rights ...	43
3.4.2 Hindering factors to child protection	44
3.5 Baseline Programme Indicators and Outcome Progress Markers	46
4.0 SUMMARY, CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS	51
4.1 Summary of key findings	51
4.2 Conclusion	52
4.3 Practical recommendations	53
4.3.1 practical recommendations to strengthen programme implementation	53
4.3.2 Practical recommendations to strengthen policy advocacy	53
4.3.3 Practical recommendations to strengthen institutional coordination	54
4.3.4 Practical recommendations to strengthen community engagement	55
4.3.5 Practical recommendations to strengthen organizational learning, and adaptive management	56
5.0 APPENDICES	57
5.1 Updated Results matrix	57

LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS

ADR: Alternative Dispute Resolution

ASAL: Arid and Semi-Arid Lands

AYSRH: Adolescent and Youth Sexual and Reproductive Health

CACs: County Advisory Councils

CCAC: County Children Advisory Councils

CHPs: Community Health Promoters

CHVs: Community Health Volunteers

CIDP: County Integrated Development Plan

CSOs: Civil Society Organizations

DCS: Directorate of Children's Services

EACHRights: The East African Centre for Human Rights

FGDs: Focus Group Discussions

FGM/C: Female Genital Mutilation/Cutting

FTE: Full-Time Equivalent

GBV: Gender-Based Violence

IN: Indicator

KABC: Knowledge, Attitudes, Behaviours, and Capacities

KCA: Kenya Children Assemblies

KIIs: Key Informant Interviews

LFA: Logical Framework Analysis

LOE: Level of Effort

MEAL: Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability, and Learning

MSDs: Multi-Stakeholder Dialogues

NCIC: National Cohesion and Integration Commission

NGOs: Non-Governmental Organizations

NVC: Non-Violent Communication

PM: Progress Marker

PSEHA: Protection against Sexual Exploitation, Hypocrisy, and Abuse

SDGs: Sustainable Development Goals

SGBV: Sexual and Gender-Based Violence

SRHR: Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights

UNCRC: United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child

UPR: Universal Periodic Review

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The successful completion of the **Safer Futures Project (Watoto Wetu Phase IV)** baseline study was made possible through the collaborative efforts and dedication of numerous individuals and institutions. We wish to express our sincere gratitude to **ERIKS Development Partner** for their generous financial support, which enabled the execution of this comprehensive baseline assessment across **Garissa, Marsabit, Homa Bay, Kwale, and Migori Counties**.

Special thanks are extended to the leadership and the entire team at **The East African Centre for Human Rights (EACHRights)** for their technical guidance and logistical coordination. We specifically recognize **CEO and Team Leader Gilbert Onyango** for his strategic oversight, as well as **Project Manager Marcellino Waithaka Thuku** and **Madina** for their tireless efforts in mobilizing respondents, coordinating field activities in complex environments, and providing critical clarifications throughout the study process.

We also extend our heartfelt appreciation to the diverse groups of participants from the target counties who generously shared their time, lived experiences, and invaluable insights. This includes the children and youth from the **Kenya Children Assemblies**, caregivers, community members, religious and traditional leaders, and government duty-bearers whose contributions helped establish these foundational benchmarks.

Finally, we commend the dedicated team at **Desdemona Consulting Group Limited**, including **Francis Omillo, Adan, Edwin, Benedict, Laura, Sylvia, and Fatuma**, for their professional execution of the study. Their expertise in managing data collection, conducting rigorous analysis, and spearheading the writing of this report was essential to the study's success. This collective commitment ensures that the Safer Futures Project is grounded in a robust evidence base as it works toward the realization of children's rights between **2026 and 2028**.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The **Safer Futures Project (Watoto Wetu Phase IV)** is a three-year initiative (2026–2028) implemented by **EACHRights** in partnership with **ERIKS Development Partner** and **Cord Global**. Operating in **Garissa, Marsabit, Homa Bay, Kwale, and Migori Counties**, the project aims to establish resilient communities where children are protected from violence, exploitation, and harmful practices such as FGM and child marriage. This baseline study, conducted in early 2026, provides a comprehensive benchmark for the project's four core pillars: **Child Governance, Protection/SRHR Systems, Peacebuilding, and Environmental Resilience**

The Baseline Reality: Key Findings

The assessment reveals a significant "Implementation Gap"—a contrast between high individual rights awareness and low systemic support.

1. **Child Protection Systems:** While structures exist, they are rated with **low adequacy (2.50/5.0)**. Systems are currently hindered by severe personnel shortages, inadequate funding, and a reliance on informal **"Kangaroo courts"** that often bypass formal justice.
2. **Harmful Practices:** Retrogressive norms remain **highly prevalent**. Community actors rated **FGM (4.50/5.0)**, **child labour (4.33/5.0)**, and **child marriage (4.25/5.0)** as persistent threats that disproportionately impact girls.
3. **Child Participation:** Children demonstrate **high individual confidence (4.1/5.0)** and rights knowledge (4.2/5.0). **100% of surveyed children** report they are actively speaking up for their rights. However, meaningful engagement is often blocked by "adult disbelief" and lack of safe, anonymous reporting channels.
4. **Sexual & Reproductive Health (SRHR):** Knowledge of body rights is high (4.2/5.0), but children feel only **moderately safe (3.3/5.0)** discussing these topics in public dialogue spaces. Access to youth-friendly services remains inconsistent across the counties.
5. **Emerging Thematic Gaps:** There is a notable **knowledge-action gap** in newer areas. While staff understand peacebuilding and climate theory, the routine frequency of conducting conflict analysis (1.75/5.0) and technical child-climate assessments (2.50/5.0) is low

Strategic Drivers

Enabling Strengths	Primary Hindrances
Robust Legal Frameworks: Anchored in Kenya's Children Act 2022 and the UNCRC.	Socio-Cultural Norms: Entrenched beliefs prioritizing tradition over statutory law.
Active Platforms: The Kenya Children Assemblies (KCAs) provide a primary vehicle for child leadership.	The "Triple Threat": Overlapping vulnerabilities of climate shocks (droughts), insecurity, and pervasive poverty.
Institutional Capacity: EACHRights possesses high confidence in advocacy (4.0/5.0) and social norm change (4.25/5.0).	Operational Bottlenecks: Poor data sharing, weak inter-agency coordination, and geographic remoteness.

Strategic Recommendations for 2026–2028

1. **Strengthen System Functionality:** Institutionalize **standardized, digitalized referral protocols** to prevent children from "falling through the system" during the reporting stage.
2. **Engage "Moral Duty-Bearers":** Transform traditional and religious leaders into **"Champions of Change"** to bridge the gap between cultural practices and formal child protection laws.
3. **Bridge the Technical Gap:** Prioritize staff capacity building in **trauma-informed implementation** and **technical climate analysis** to ensure these themes are integrated into routine field activities.
4. **Enhance Accountability:** Leverage high-level advocacy networks (like the UPR) to lobby for the **finalization of pending county policies** in Garissa and Marsabit.
5. **Reconstruct Trust:** Foster **intergenerational dialogues** to reduce "cultural shyness" and empower parents to support their children's participation in rights-based decisions.

Ultimately, this baseline serves as an **evidence-based roadmap** for the project, ensuring that interventions are tailored to move the target counties from fragile awareness to resilient, child-centered protection systems.

1.0 INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Background

The **Safer Futures Project (Watoto Wetu Phase IV)** is a three-year child rights and protection initiative implemented by **The East African Centre for Human Rights (EACHRights)** in partnership with **ERIKS Development Partner** and **Cord Global** from **January 2026 to December 2028** across **Garissa, Marsabit, Homa Bay, Kwale, and Migori Counties**. The project seeks to strengthen an enabling environment in which children are protected from violence, exploitation, abuse, child marriage, female genital mutilation (FGM), trafficking, and other harmful practices while empowering them to actively participate in decisions affecting their lives. The intervention adopts a child rights-based approach that promotes meaningful child participation, strengthened child protection and sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR) systems, community-led peacebuilding, environmental resilience, and institutional capacity strengthening. It is aligned with the **United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC)**, the **African Charter on the Rights and Welfare of the Child**, **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) 3, 5, 10, 13 and 16**, Kenya's **Children Act, 2022**, the **National Prevention and Response Plan on Violence Against Children**, and other national and county policy frameworks that seek to safeguard children's rights and wellbeing.

The five project counties present diverse but interconnected child protection challenges that continue to undermine children's survival, development, participation, and protection. Garissa and Marsabit remain among the counties with persistently high prevalence of FGM and child marriage, driven by deeply entrenched socio-cultural norms, gender inequality, and weak enforcement of child protection legislation. Homa Bay, Kwale, and Migori continue to experience high rates of adolescent pregnancy, school dropout, gender-based violence (GBV), child labour, and limited access to adolescent-friendly SRHR information and services. In Marsabit, recurrent inter-community conflict, insecurity, and displacement weaken social cohesion, interrupt education, and expose children to multiple protection risks. Across all implementation areas, recurrent droughts, climate variability, environmental degradation, and economic vulnerabilities continue to exacerbate poverty, food insecurity, household stress, and negative coping mechanisms that disproportionately affect children, particularly girls, children with disabilities, and marginalized communities. These complex and overlapping vulnerabilities highlight the need for integrated interventions that strengthen community resilience while reinforcing child protection and accountability systems.

Recognizing that sustainable improvements in children's wellbeing require behavioural, institutional, and systemic change, the Safer Futures Project works with children, caregivers, schools, community structures, civil society organizations, religious and traditional leaders, and government duty-bearers to strengthen community ownership of child protection and promote positive social norms. The project focuses on enhancing children's participation in governance and advocacy, strengthening referral and protection mechanisms, improving access to quality SRHR information and services, integrating child-sensitive peacebuilding approaches in conflict-affected communities, promoting environmental stewardship and climate resilience, and building the organizational and advocacy capacities of local partners. Through these complementary interventions, the programme seeks to create safer, more inclusive, and resilient communities where children can exercise their rights and reach their full potential.

The baseline study was undertaken at the inception of the project to establish the **January 2026 baseline status** of key programme indicators before implementation of project interventions. Specifically, the study assesses existing levels of child participation, prevalence and drivers of harmful practices, functionality of child protection and referral systems, access to SRHR information and services, institutional capacities, peacebuilding mechanisms, environmental resilience, and the enabling and constraining factors influencing the realization of children's rights across the five target counties. Using a mixed-methods approach, the assessment generates both quantitative baseline values and qualitative evidence to inform programme planning, refine implementation strategies, strengthen adaptive management and learning, and provide benchmark indicators for monitoring progress and evaluating project achievements during the midterm and endline evaluations. The findings will also support evidence-based decision-making, accountability to stakeholders, and continuous learning throughout the 2026–2028 implementation period.

1.2 Project Goal

The goal of the **Safer Futures (Watoto Wetu Phase IV)** project is to contribute to the realization of children's rights by strengthening protective, inclusive, and resilient communities where children are safe from violence, exploitation, abuse, child marriage, female genital mutilation (FGM), trafficking, and other harmful practices. The project seeks to empower children, adolescents, families, and communities to promote meaningful child participation, strengthen child protection and sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR) systems, enhance peacebuilding and social cohesion in conflict-prone

areas, and foster climate resilience through strengthened institutional capacity, community engagement, and evidence-based advocacy. The intervention is anchored on a child rights-based approach and contributes to national and international commitments, including the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC), the African Charter on the Rights and Welfare of the Child, and Kenya's Children Act, 2022.

1.3 Project Outcomes

The baseline study assessed the pre-intervention status of the four intended outcomes of the Safer Futures (Watoto Wetu Phase IV) project to establish benchmark values for monitoring programme performance throughout the implementation period (2026–2028). Specifically, the study examined the following outcomes:

1. **Children are actively engaged in child protection and governance processes** through strengthened child participation platforms, increased awareness of child rights, enhanced reporting mechanisms, and meaningful participation in decision-making within families, schools, communities, and public institutions.
2. **Communities contribute to effective child protection and sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR) systems** through strengthened community-based protection mechanisms, improved referral pathways, increased collaboration between civil society organizations and government duty-bearers, enhanced access to child-friendly SRHR information and services, and collective action to prevent child marriage, FGM, gender-based violence, trafficking, and other harmful practices.
3. **Communities contribute to effective peacebuilding and social cohesion**, particularly in conflict-affected areas, through strengthened peace structures, conflict-sensitive programming, inclusive community dialogue, integration of child protection into peacebuilding initiatives, and increased participation of children, women, youth, and community leaders in conflict prevention and resolution.
4. **Communities contribute to a safe, healthy, and climate-resilient environment** by promoting environmental conservation, climate change adaptation, disaster risk reduction, household resilience, and community participation in environmental governance to safeguard children's wellbeing and sustainable livelihoods.

1.4 Purpose of the Baseline Study

The purpose of the baseline study was to establish the **January 2026 baseline status** of the Safer Futures (Watoto Wetu Phase IV) programme prior to full-scale implementation of project interventions. The study generated comprehensive quantitative and qualitative evidence on the prevailing child protection, child participation, harmful cultural practices, SRHR, peacebuilding, environmental resilience, and institutional capacity contexts across the five implementation counties. The assessment established benchmark values for programme indicators and outcome progress markers, examined the behaviours, relationships, capacities, and systems influencing children's rights, and identified contextual opportunities and barriers that could affect programme implementation. The findings provide a robust evidence base for adaptive programme management, monitoring, learning, accountability, annual reviews, outcome harvesting, midterm and endline evaluations, while supporting evidence-based decision-making by EACHRights, ERIKS Development Partner, Cord Global, county governments, and other stakeholders.

1.5 Objectives of the Baseline Study

The baseline study sought to achieve the following objectives:

1. Establish the baseline status of child protection, child participation, harmful cultural practices, sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR), peacebuilding, environmental resilience, and institutional capacity across the project implementation counties.
2. Assess existing knowledge, attitudes, behaviours, practices, relationships, and capacities among key rights holders and duty-bearers, including children, adolescents, caregivers, community members, civil society organizations, schools, traditional and religious leaders, and government institutions.
3. Examine the functionality, accessibility, effectiveness, and coordination of existing child protection, SRHR, peacebuilding, environmental governance, and referral systems operating at county and community levels.
4. Identify the social, cultural, institutional, governance, environmental, gender, and conflict-related factors that facilitate or hinder the realization of children's rights and the achievement of the project's intended outcomes.

5. Establish baseline values for programme indicators and outcome progress markers that will provide reference points for routine monitoring, adaptive management, outcome harvesting, annual reviews, the midterm review, and the endline evaluation.
6. Generate practical, evidence-based recommendations to strengthen programme implementation, policy engagement, institutional collaboration, community participation, and organizational learning throughout the implementation period of the Safer Futures (Watoto Wetu Phase IV) project.

1.6 Scope of the baseline study

The baseline study was undertaken over a **30-day period from 8 July to 6 August 2026** to establish the pre-intervention status of the **Safer Futures (Watoto Wetu Phase IV)** project across the five implementation counties of **Garissa, Marsabit, Homa Bay, Kwale, and Migori**. The assessment focused on generating baseline evidence on child protection, child participation, harmful cultural practices, sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR), peacebuilding, environmental resilience, and institutional capacity prior to the commencement of full project implementation. The study covered both rights holders and duty bearers, including children, caregivers, community members, Children's Assemblies, peace committees, civil society organizations, traditional and religious leaders, schools, health facilities, and relevant county government departments. Using a mixed-methods approach, the study incorporated a desk review, quantitative surveys, **44 key informant interviews (KIIs)**, and **three focus group discussions (FGDs)** comprising two Children's Assemblies and one Peace Committee. The findings provide benchmark values for the project's outcome indicators and progress markers and establish an evidence base to guide programme implementation, monitoring, adaptive management, learning, the midterm review, and the endline evaluation throughout the 2026–2028 implementation period.

2.0 BASELINE METHODOLOGY AND APPROACH

2.1 Methodology

The baseline study adopted a cross-sectional mixed-methods design anchored on the Outcome Mapping framework to establish the pre-intervention status of child protection, child participation, sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR), peacebuilding, and environmental resilience across the five project counties of Garissa, Marsabit, Homa Bay, Kwale, and Migori. The study combined quantitative and qualitative approaches to generate comprehensive baseline evidence on prevailing behaviours, institutional capacities, social norms, governance systems, and contextual factors affecting the realization of children's rights. Data were collected from both rights holders and duty bearers, including children, caregivers, community members, civil society organizations, schools, health facilities, religious and traditional leaders, and county government institutions.

Qualitative data collection was undertaken through **44 Key Informant Interviews (KIIs)** and **three Focus Group Discussions (FGDs)**. The KIIs targeted a broad range of stakeholders, including officials from county government departments, the Directorate of Children's Services, health facilities, schools, police, judiciary, civil society organizations, religious and traditional leaders, and child protection actors, to generate insights into institutional capacities, policy implementation, service delivery, coordination mechanisms, and community practices. The FGDs comprised **two Children Assembly discussions** and **one Peace Committee discussion**, providing deeper understanding of children's participation, community perceptions, peacebuilding dynamics, social norms, and the challenges affecting child protection and wellbeing.

The study was complemented by a comprehensive desk review of project documents, national policies, county development plans, administrative datasets, and previous assessments to contextualize the findings. Quantitative data were analyzed using descriptive statistics, while qualitative data underwent thematic content analysis guided by the Outcome Mapping framework. Evidence from the desk review, KIIs, FGDs, and other data sources was triangulated to enhance the validity and credibility of the findings, providing a robust baseline against which project progress will be monitored and evaluated throughout the implementation period.

2.2 Baseline Study Limitations

Despite the successful completion of the baseline study, several limitations were encountered during data collection that should be considered when interpreting the findings.

1. **Limited Time for Fieldwork:** The baseline assessment was conducted within a relatively short timeframe, which constrained the duration available for data collection, follow-up interviews, and in-depth engagement with stakeholders across the five project counties. Although careful planning and deployment of experienced field teams minimized these effects, the limited time reduced opportunities for prolonged observation and repeated visits to some communities.
2. **Availability of Key Informants:** Securing appointments with some key informants, particularly county government officials, religious leaders, school administrators, and other duty bearers, proved challenging due to competing official responsibilities and pre-scheduled engagements. In a few instances, interviews had to be rescheduled or conducted virtually, which occasionally affected the depth and timing of information collected.
3. **Language and Communication Barriers:** The study was undertaken in culturally diverse counties where respondents spoke different local languages and dialects, including Somali, Borana, Dholuo, Kigiryama, and Kuria. Although local research assistants and translators supported data collection, translation and interpretation occasionally resulted in minor variations in the expression of local concepts and experiences, particularly when discussing sensitive issues such as FGM, child marriage, and sexual and reproductive health.
4. **Sensitivity of Child Protection and SRHR Topics:** Discussions on child protection, gender-based violence, FGM, child marriage, trafficking, and adolescent sexual and reproductive health are highly sensitive within many of the study communities. Some respondents were hesitant to openly discuss these issues because of cultural norms, fear of stigma, or concerns about confidentiality. The study team mitigated this challenge by ensuring informed consent, maintaining confidentiality, and employing child-sensitive and gender-responsive interviewing techniques.
5. **Geographical and Logistical Challenges:** Some project locations, particularly in remote and hard-to-reach areas of Garissa and Marsabit Counties, were difficult to access due to long travel distances, poor road infrastructure, and challenging weather conditions. These logistical constraints increased travel time and operational costs and occasionally affected adherence to the planned field schedule. However,

close coordination with EACHRights staff, county authorities, and community leaders enabled the study team to complete the planned data collection activities successfully.

3.0 BASELINE STUDY FINDINGS

3.1 Baseline Status of Child Protection, Child Participation, SRHR, Peacebuilding, Environmental Resilience, and Institutional Capacity

This section presents the prevailing situation across the five project counties, including the status of child protection systems, children's participation, harmful practices, SRHR, peacebuilding, environmental resilience, and organizational capacity before project implementation.

3.1.1 Status of child protection systems

The baseline study for the **Safer Futures Project** reveals a child protection landscape characterized by a mix of formal and informal structures that are currently viewed with **low-to-moderate adequacy**. While systems for reporting and referral exist, they are hindered by systemic resource gaps and entrenched socio-cultural norms.

Respondents used a 5-point scale (1 lowest, 5 highest) to rate various aspects of the existing child protection system. The scores reflect a **low perception of state responsiveness and service effectiveness**:

Indicator	Baseline Mean Score	Perceived Status
Adequacy of national child protection services	2.50	Low
Authorities addressing system weaknesses	2.50	Low
Adequacy of national child protection policies	2.75	Low-to-Moderate
Impact of CSO collaboration	2.75	Low-to-Moderate
Government prioritization of child protection	3.25	Moderate
Local community actor collaboration	3.50	Moderate

Core Mechanisms of the Protection Ecosystem

The current landscape consists of a diverse mix of **formal, informal, and community-led structures**:

1. **Statutory Bodies:** County Advisory Councils (CACs), Children Advisory Committees, and Gender and Child Protection Working Groups.
2. **Community-Led Structures: Child Protection Committees** (identified as a universal mechanism), **Nyumba Kumi** administrative units, and local dispute resolution systems.
3. **Child-Centered Platforms: Kenya Children Assemblies (KCAs)** and school-based child protection clubs that facilitate direct child participation.
4. **Grassroots Networks:** Community Health Promoters (CHPs), Child Protection Champions, and multi-sectoral referral networks.

Key Systemic Constraints

The effectiveness of these systems is currently undermined by several **operational and socio-cultural bottlenecks**:

1. **Resource Deficits:** Severe **shortages of trained personnel** and inadequate budget allocations prevent timely responses and case follow-ups.
2. **Coordination Gaps:** Weak alignment between national and county governments, fragmented case management, and **poor data sharing** hinder unified protection efforts.
3. **Infrastructure Barriers:** Geographic remoteness and poor roads, especially in ASAL regions like Garissa and Marsabit, restrict the reach of services.
4. **Socio-Cultural Pressures:** Entrenched norms often lead to the use of **informal "Kangaroo courts"** or "Maslah" systems, which can suppress the formal reporting of violations.
5. **Trust and Awareness:** A disconnect between state duty-bearers and local communities has resulted in **distrust** and low public awareness of formal reporting pathways.

Stakeholder Participation

Collaboration within the ecosystem is broad but varies in intensity. While **100% of reported cases** involved local authorities and frontline services (education, law enforcement), parental involvement was only cited in **50% of responses**. Notably, **children themselves** are emerging as active participants in these collaborative frameworks through child-led advocacy.

3.1.2 Status of children's Participation

The baseline status of **children's participation** in the target counties reveals a landscape where structured platforms exist and children demonstrate high individual confidence, yet meaningful engagement remains inconsistent due to socio-cultural and systemic barriers.

Based on surveys with children and staff, participation and knowledge levels are generally rated as **moderate-to-high**, though adult support and policy integration show room for improvement:

Indicator	Baseline Score (out of 5)	Perceived Status
Children's knowledge of their rights	4.2	High
Children's knowledge of right to protection	4.2	High
Confidence to lead community activities	4.1	High
Support received to advocate for rights	4.4	High
Staff confidence in child-rights advocacy	4.0	High
Staff confidence in self-assessing participation	3.5	Moderately High
Adult support for child/youth platforms	3.4	Moderate
Safety to discuss SRHR in dialogue spaces	3.3	Moderate

Primary Participation Platforms

Children engage through a variety of formal and digital mechanisms, though the **Kenya Children Assemblies (KCAs)** serve as the primary vehicle.

1. **Kenya Children Assemblies:** These are "very active" in Marsabit (Laisamis) and "somewhat active" in Garissa (North Horr/Township). They allow children to identify challenges, share lived experiences, and influence policy dialogue.
2. **School-Based Mechanisms:** Children participate in **child rights clubs**, serve as class representatives, and contribute to shaping school rules.

3. **Digital and Resource Tools:** EACHRights will collaborate with Mtoto News, an organisation specialising in child participation and child-focused digital engagement, to strengthen meaningful, ethical and safe engagement of children and young people. The engagement will be guided by relevant Mtoto News resources, alongside the Lundy Model of Participation and Ladder of Participation, to ensure that children's voices are heard, valued and incorporated safely and meaningfully throughout the process.
4. **Feedback Loops:** Mechanisms include child-friendly reflection meetings, suggestion boxes, beneficiary satisfaction surveys, and community dialogue forums

Scope of Decision-Making

Participation extends beyond mere consultation into active leadership and community development:

1. **Advocacy: 100% of surveyed children** reported they are actively speaking up and advocating for their rights.
2. **Community Leadership: 90% of surveyed children** have led or initiated community development activities.
3. **Decision-Making: 80% of children** reported participating in community decisions, including **SRHR planning, conflict resolution, and peacebuilding**.
4. **Policy Inclusion:** While **82% of duty-bearers** claim to include children's perspectives in policy development via the KCAs and public barazas, some acknowledge that this is not yet a universal practice.

Key Barriers to Meaningful Participation

Despite high individual confidence, children face several hurdles when attempting to share their views with local authorities and families:

1. **Socio-Cultural Norms:** Deeply entrenched **cultural taboos** and "Kangaroo Courts" often prevent children from speaking openly about rights violations.
2. **Adult Disbelief:** Children report that duty-bearers sometimes do not listen to them because they are "**presumed to be not able to raise issues**" or are simply not believed due to their age.
3. **Institutional Gaps:** Barriers include a **lack of specific platforms** for engagement, victimization of those who speak up, and inefficient reporting channels.

4. **Communication Barriers:** In some contexts, **language differences** between children and government officials make it difficult to understand one another.
5. **Parental Engagement:** Discussions with parents on sensitive topics like body changes or romantic relationships are often avoided due to **shyness or cultural restrictions**

3.1.3 Status of Harmful practices

The baseline findings for the **Safer Futures Project** indicate that harmful practices remain deeply entrenched and **highly prevalent** across the target counties. These practices are driven by persistent social norms and are perceived by partner organizations as major threats to the realization of children's rights.

Prevalence of Harmful Practices

Respondents rated the prevalence of various harmful practices on a 5-point scale (1 being the lowest, 5 being the highest). The scores indicate that most practices are **highly common** in the community:

Harmful Practice	Baseline Score	Mean Perceived Status
Female Genital Mutilation (FGM)	4.50	Highly Prevalent
Child Labour	4.33	Highly Prevalent
Child Marriage	4.25	Highly Prevalent
Gender-Based Violence (GBV)	4.25	Highly Prevalent
Child Trafficking	3.50	Moderately Prevalent

Key Drivers and Influencers

Harmful attitudes are widely embedded in community norms and are perpetuated across different demographic groups:

1. **Primary Influencers:** Harmful norms are primarily reinforced by **older generations** (older men and women) and **community decision-makers**, though they are also transmitted to younger groups.

2. **Cultural Justifications:** Practices like FGM/C and early marriage are often socially accepted as cultural rites of passage or necessary for social inclusion.
3. **Barriers to Change:** Entrenched religious and cultural beliefs frequently conflict with statutory child protection laws, leading to the use of "Kangaroo courts" and a general lack of political will to enforce anti-FGM or child protection policies

Impact on Children and Gender Dynamics

There is **100% consensus** among respondents that harmful practices impact boys and girls differently, with girls bearing a disproportionate burden due to systemic inequality:

1. **Vulnerabilities for Girls:** Girls face severe, multi-faceted risks, including **FGM/C, child marriage, early adolescent pregnancy**, and high rates of sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV).
2. **Vulnerabilities for Boys:** Boys are more likely to face risks related to **child labour** and **human trafficking**, in addition to male circumcision as a cultural rite.
3. **Physical and Mental Health:** Survivors often suffer from acute psychological distress, trauma, reduced self-esteem, and elevated risks of HIV infection.
4. **Educational Consequences:** These practices drive severe disruptions, leading to high rates of **absenteeism and school dropout**, which perpetuates intergenerational cycles of poverty

Institutional and Community Capacity

While the challenge is significant, the sources highlight a foundation for intervention:

1. **Staff Confidence:** Project staff report a **high level of confidence (4.25/5)** in their ability to raise awareness and challenge harmful norms and stereotypes.
2. **Available Mitigation:** Some initiatives like **girls' life skills training** exist, but their current status is rated as **moderate to inadequate (2.75/5)**, indicating a need for expansion.
3. **Engagement:** Religious and traditional leaders are recognized as influential "moral duty-bearers" whose involvement is critical for shifting these social norms.

3.1.4 Status of SRHR

The baseline status of **Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR)** across the project counties is characterized by **high levels of individual awareness among children**, contrasted with **moderate-to-low systemic adequacy** in service delivery and persistent cultural barriers. While children report being knowledgeable about their bodies and rights, actual access to "youth-friendly" services remains inconsistent.

Based on surveys with children and partner organization staff, the following baseline values (on a 1–5 scale) highlight the gap between knowledge and the safety of the environment:

Indicator	Baseline Score	Mean	Perceived Status
Child knowledge of body rights and SRHR	4.2		High
Staff confidence to develop SRHR education	4.2		High
Staff confidence to collaborate with health providers	4.1		High
Child confidence to make informed health decisions	3.9		High
Child knowledge of SRHR concepts	3.5		Moderate-to-High
Safety to talk about SRHR in dialogue spaces	3.3		Moderate
Adequacy of girls' life skills training	2.75		Low-to-Moderate

SRHR Service and Participation Landscape

The current SRHR ecosystem is in an **emerging phase**, with several mechanisms in place but not yet fully institutionalized across all project areas:

1. **Service Access:** Most children (90%) report knowing where to find maternal and SRHR services. However, interventions to ensure this knowledge are described as "limited but developing".

2. **Safe Spaces:** Safe dialogue spaces for girls exist through adolescent corners, "Binti kwa Binti" forums, and school clubs, yet safety to speak freely within these spaces is only rated as **moderate (3.3/5)**.
3. **Child Participation:** Children are increasingly involved in health decisions, including **actual planning on SRHR** and contributing to family planning discussions.
4. **Peer Education:** Capacity for peer-led programs is currently "limited but emerging," with a clear commitment to expand these under the Safer Futures Project.

Key Vulnerabilities and Barriers

The realization of SRHR is hindered by a combination of geographic, cultural, and systemic issues:

1. **Geographic Disparities:** Homa Bay, Kwale, and Migori are specifically noted for **high rates of adolescent pregnancy** and limited access to adolescent-friendly services.
2. **Cultural Taboos:** Deeply entrenched norms and "cultural shyness" often prevent children from discussing body changes or romantic relationships with parents.
3. **Communication Gaps:** Children report that shyness and cultural restrictions make it "very hard" to ask parents questions about SRHR.
4. **Support Disparities:** While 90% of children have a safe space for health talk, actual **peer education components** are not yet implemented in all projects, including the current Watoto Wetu project

Organizational and Advocacy Capacity

EACHRights and its partners demonstrate **strong foundational capacity** to move the SRHR agenda forward:

1. **Advocacy:** The organization works closely with health departments to advocate for adolescent-friendly policies and budget allocations.
2. **Referral Pathways:** Existing interventions focus on linking young mothers and adolescents to health facilities for **antenatal care, contraceptives, and STI screening**.
3. **Educational Support:** Efforts include promoting **school re-entry policies** for young mothers and providing life skills training to enhance resilience

3.1.5 Status of Peace Building

The baseline status of **Peacebuilding and Social Cohesion** within the Safer Futures Project highlights an emerging focus area, particularly critical for conflict-prone regions like Marsabit. While foundational knowledge of peacebuilding concepts exists among project staff, there is a significant gap between theoretical understanding and the routine application of these practices in the field.

The study assessed staff on two fronts: their **competency** (knowledge/training) and their **operational frequency** (how often they use the skill) on a 5-point scale.

Peacebuilding Indicator	Staff Competency (Mean)	Perceived Status	Operational Frequency (Mean)	Frequency Status
Conflict Analysis	3.50	Moderate	1.75	Very Low
Non-Violent Communication	3.50	Moderate	2.25	Low-to-Moderate
Conflict Sensitivity	3.00	Moderate	2.25	Low-to-Moderate
Trauma-Informed Implementation	2.75	Low-to-Moderate	2.00	Low

Core Peacebuilding Mechanisms

The project integrates peacebuilding through several structured community and institutional approaches:

1. **Peace Committees:** Dedicated community-level forums for discussion and conflict mitigation.
2. **Inclusive Community Dialogues:** Multi-stakeholder platforms involving children, families, religious leaders, and local authorities to foster social cohesion.
3. **Child Participation in Conflict Resolution:** Children in Marsabit and Garissa specifically reported participating in "resolving youth conflicts" and "peacebuilding" within their communities.

4. **Conflict-Sensitive Programming:** Efforts to ensure that project interventions do not inadvertently exacerbate local tensions, though confidence in executing this remains moderate.

Contextual Drivers of Conflict

The need for these systems is driven by specific vulnerabilities identified in the project counties:

1. **Inter-Community Dynamics:** Marsabit is specifically noted for recurrent inter-community conflict, insecurity, and displacement, which frequently interrupt children's education.
2. **Climate and Resources:** Recurrent droughts and environmental degradation in Garissa and Marsabit exacerbate household stress and can trigger competition over limited resources.
3. **Historical Trauma:** Many communities in these regions are heavily impacted by violence and historical trauma, making peacebuilding essential for child protection.

Key Systemic and Operational Gaps

The baseline identifies several barriers to establishing a robust peacebuilding framework:

1. **Routine Integration Gap:** There is a "very low routine integration" of formal conflict analysis, with most staff conducting it only once a year or never.
2. **Limited Trauma-Informed Readiness:** Most staff possess only basic theoretical knowledge of trauma-informed practices and lack the confidence to apply them in regions affected by SGBV and displacement.
3. **Confidence vs. Execution:** While half the team has formal training in conflict analysis, the other half lacks the confidence to execute these skills independently in the field.
4. **Sustainability of Dialogue:** Although confidence in using dialogue to discuss sensitive issues is moderate (3.25/5), these approaches are not yet consistently institutionalized across all project areas.

3.1.6 Status of environmental resilience

The baseline status of **environmental resilience** within the Safer Futures Project highlights a critical intersection between climate change and child

rights, particularly in the Arid and Semi-Arid Lands (ASAL). While the project identifies environmental stewardship as a core outcome, current organizational capacity to analyze these links is in a developing phase.

The study measured the self-reported confidence of EACHRights staff in conducting various types of environmental assessments (on a scale of 1 to 5). The results show a **strong capacity in social-environmental intersections** but a significant gap in technical environmental analysis:

Assessment Indicator	Baseline Mean Score	Perceived Status
Gender equality within environmental assessment	3.75	High
"Do No Harm" principles in environmental contexts	3.50	Moderate-to-High
Conflict sensitivity in environmental assessment	3.25	Moderate
Technical analysis of child-climate impacts	2.50	Low-to-Moderate

Contextual Environmental Vulnerabilities

The target counties, particularly **Garissa and Marsabit**, face severe environmental stressors that directly undermine children's development and protection:

1. **Recurrent Climate Shocks:** Frequent droughts and climate variability exacerbate poverty and food insecurity.
2. **Environmental Degradation:** Declining natural resources leads to increased household stress and the adoption of negative coping mechanisms.
3. **Disproportionate Impact:** These stressors most heavily affect **girls, children with disabilities, and marginalized communities**, often leading to school dropouts or increased exposure to harmful practices.
4. **Child-Reported Concerns:** In focus group discussions, children themselves identified "climate-related concerns" as one of the most pressing issues affecting their lives.

Organizational Foundation and Capacity Gaps

EACHRights is well-positioned to address these issues through its established **Environment and Climate Justice program**, though technical refinements are required:

1. **Foundational Readiness:** The staff demonstrates a solid understanding of **risk mitigation and safeguards** (Do No Harm) when carrying out climate-related activities.
2. **Technical Gaps:** There is a "critical gap" in technical familiarity regarding **environmental child rights analysis**, with 75% of staff reporting very little confidence in this specific area.
3. **Programmatic Integration:** While the organization routinely evaluates social and cultural dynamics before rollout, there is a clear need to **institutionalize conflict-sensitive and trauma-informed methodologies** into environmental work, especially in conflict-prone areas like Marsabit.

The Path Forward

The project aims to move from this baseline toward an environment where communities actively participate in **environmental governance and disaster risk reduction**. To achieve this, the report emphasizes the necessity for planned **technical capacity-building** for staff to better link climate adaptation strategies with specific child protection outcomes

3.1.7 organizational capacity before project implementation

The organizational capacity of **EACHRights** at the baseline stage (January 2026) reflects a **mature institution** with high proficiency in advocacy and child rights analysis, but with specific **technical gaps** in newer focus areas like environmental resilience and trauma-informed care.

1. The Institutional Profile. EACHRights is a regional civil society organization established in **2010** with a mandate to promote economic and social rights for marginalized populations.

- a) **Presence:** Operates in **9 Kenyan counties** (including Garissa, Marsabit, and Homa Bay) and regionally in **Uganda and Tanzania**.
- b) **Thematic Focus:** Specializes in child protection, **SRHR**, gender equality, education, and peacebuilding.
- c) **Staffing:** Maintains a blend of institutional continuity (staff with up to 9 years of service) and newer team members.

2. The Competency Spectrum (Self-Assessed Scores out of 5.0). *The organization demonstrates high confidence in its core "traditional" strengths, while technical "emerging" areas show room for growth:*

High proficiency (4.0+ / 5.0)

- a) **Raising Awareness on Harmful Norms (4.25):** Strongest capacity; staff feel highly prepared to challenge social stereotypes.
- b) **Child-Rights Advocacy (4.0):** High institutional confidence in influencing policy and engaging stakeholders.

Moderate/solid foundation (3.0 – 3.5 / 5.0)

- a) **Gender Analysis (3.75):** Strong ability to analyze gender impacts within environmental assessments.
- b) **Non-Violent Communication (3.5):** Trained and occasionally utilizing these skills.
- c) **Conflict Analysis (3.5):** Half of the team is formally trained, while others have foundational knowledge.
- d) **Self-Assessment of Child Participation (3.5):** Solid understanding of process, though reflective learning could be improved.
- e) **Religious Literacy (3.0):** Moderate capability to engage religious leaders as "moral duty-bearers".

Critical capacity gaps (< 3.0 / 5.0)

- a) **Trauma-Informed Implementation (2.75):** Limited readiness; most staff lack the confidence to apply trauma principles in conflict settings.
- b) **Technical Environmental Analysis (2.5):** A "critical gap" exists in the technical familiarity required for environmental child rights analysis.

3. The Child Participation Toolkit

EACHRights has institutionalized a robust set of tools to ensure safe and meaningful engagement:

- a) **a) Child Engagement Support:** Collaboration with Mtoto News, an organisation specialising in child participation and engagement, to support meaningful, ethical and safe engagement of children and young people through appropriate digital and participatory approaches.
- b) **Models:** Adoption of the **Lundy Model**, **Ladder of Participation**, and **Balance Model**.

- c) **Feedback Loops:** Mechanisms include child-friendly suggestion boxes, reflection meetings, and satisfaction surveys.
- d) **Policies:** Strong systems for **child safeguarding**, informed consent, and child assent protocols are in place.

4. Operational vs. Theoretical Readiness

There is a notable **disconnect** between staff knowledge and how often that knowledge is used in the field:

- a) **Child Rights Analysis:** **75%** of staff regularly conduct situation analyses, showing high routine integration.
- b) **Conflict Analysis:** Despite moderate knowledge, it is integrated with **very low frequency (1.75/5)**, often occurring only once a year.
- c) **Trauma-Informed Practice:** Application frequency is **low (2.0/5)**, with half of the team reporting they never apply these principles.
- d) **Dialogue Approaches:** Confidence is moderate (3.25/5), but application is not yet fully institutionalized across all projects.

5. Key Stakeholder Engagement

EACHRights manages a diverse multi-stakeholder ecosystem:

- a) **Primary Partners: Children and their families** are the most frequent participants in dialogue initiatives.
- b) **Accountability Platforms:** Active participation in national networks like **Girls Not Brides** and the **Universal Periodic Review (UPR)** Secretariat.
- c) **Collaborative Gaps:** Stakeholder engagement is **not yet uniform**; the involvement of traditional and religious leaders varies significantly across different projects

3.2 Knowledge, Attitudes, Behaviours, and Capacities of Rights Holders and Duty Bearers

This section examines the existing knowledge, perceptions, attitudes, behaviours, relationships, and capacities of children, adolescents, caregivers, communities, civil society organizations, traditional and religious leaders, schools, and government institutions in promoting and protecting children's rights.

3.2.1 Knowledge, Attitudes, Behaviours, and Capacities of Rights Holders

The baseline study assesses the Knowledge, Attitudes, Behaviours, and Capacities (KABC) of Rights Holders—primarily children, adolescents, and community members—across Garissa, Marsabit, Homa Bay, Kwale, and Migori Counties.

1. Rights Holders' Knowledge & Confidence

Children demonstrate a strong theoretical understanding of their rights and high confidence in their ability to lead, though technical knowledge of specific concepts like SRHR varies.

Baseline Indicator (Rights Holders)	Mean Score (1–5)	Status
Knowledge of general child rights	4.2	High
Knowledge of the right to protection	4.2	High
Confidence to lead community activities	4.1	High
Knowledge of body rights and SRHR	4.2	High
Knowledge of SRHR concepts	3.5	Moderate
Confidence to share SRHR knowledge	3.9	High

2. Participation Behaviours

Rights holders are actively moving from awareness to action, though consistent participation in formal decision-making faces some resistance.

- a) Active Advocacy: 100% of surveyed children report that they are actively speaking up and advocating for their rights.
- b) Community Leadership: 90% of children have led or initiated community development activities.
- c) Decision-Making: 80% of children report participating in community decisions, including SRHR planning, conflict resolution, and public participation forums.
- d) Reporting: While awareness of reporting channels is high, only 60% of those who know how to report have actually done so, citing fears of victimization and lack of trust.

3. Prevalent Attitudes and Social Norms

Rights holders operate in an environment where harmful traditional practices are still viewed as highly common by community actors.

Practice	Prevalence Score (1–5)	Impact Consensus
Female Genital Mutilation (FGM)	4.50	100% of respondents agree these practices impact boys and girls differently.
Child Labour	4.33	
Child Marriage	4.25	
Gender-Based Violence (GBV)	4.25	
Child Trafficking	3.50	

- a) Key Influencers: Harmful norms are primarily reinforced by older generations (men and women) and influential community decision-makers.
- b) Social Taboos: Cultural shyness remains a barrier; many children find it "very hard" to discuss body changes or romantic relationships with parents due to cultural restrictions.

4. Rights Holder Capacities and Support

- a) Peer Support: While children are confident in sharing knowledge, formal peer education capacity is currently limited but emerging.
- b) Adult Support: Children rate the support they receive from adults for their platforms (clubs/assemblies) at 3.4/5, indicating a moderate level of adult buy-in that requires further strengthening.
- c) Safe Spaces: 90% of children report having a safe space to talk about health issues, yet they only feel moderately safe (3.3/5) to actually exercise and discuss their SRHR within those spaces

3.2.2 Knowledge, Attitudes, Behaviours, and Capacities of Duty Bearers

The baseline assessment of **Duty Bearers**—encompassing government officials, religious and traditional leaders, teachers, and CSO staff—reveals a group that is highly confident in advocacy but faces significant operational and technical gaps in specialized protection areas.

1. The Capacity Dashboard (Scores out of 5.0)

Duty bearers show strong foundational skills but struggle with specialized technical applications:

- a) **Strongest Capacity: Raising Awareness on Harmful Norms (4.25)** – Staff feel highly prepared to facilitate community dialogues on social change.
- b) **High Confidence: Child-Rights Advocacy (4.0)** – There is unanimous institutional confidence in supporting rights-based initiatives.
- c) **Solid Foundation: Inter-Organizational Collaboration (3.25)** – CSOs collaborate "somewhat" to "a good deal" on joint advocacy.
- d) **Technical Gap: Trauma-Informed Implementation (2.75)** – Most duty bearers possess theoretical knowledge but lack the confidence to apply it in the field.
- e) **Critical Gap: Environmental Child Rights Analysis (2.5)** – There is a significant lack of technical familiarity in linking climate impacts to child protection.

2. Attitudes Toward Harmful Practices

Duty bearers demonstrate a clear understanding of the threats facing children but acknowledge systemic failures:

- a) **Recognition of Prevalence:** Duty bearers rate practices like **FGM (4.50)** and **Child Labour (4.33)** as "highly prevalent".
- b) **Gender Consensus: 100% of respondents** agree that harmful practices impact boys and girls differently, with girls bearing a multi-faceted and disproportionate burden.
- c) **Responsibility Acknowledgment:** Government acknowledgment of shortcomings in the CRC report is split; **50%** believe there is a "good deal" of responsibility, while **50%** perceive "very little".
- d) **Perceived Influencers:** Duty bearers identify **older generations** and community decision-makers as the primary holders of harmful cultural attitudes.

3. Behavioural Trends in Policy and Engagement

Practice often lags behind knowledge due to resource and coordination constraints:

- a) **Child Inclusion in Policy: 82% of duty bearers** claim to include children's perspectives in policy development, primarily through the **Kenya Children Assemblies (KCA)** and public barazas.
- b) **Regularity of Analysis: 75% of staff** regularly conduct child rights situation analyses, indicating it is a routine part of their programming.
- c) **Dialogue Frequency:** Dialogue to strengthen systems occurs at a **moderate/occasional level (3.0)**, with most engagement happening only "sometimes".
- d) **Conflict Analysis Usage:** Despite moderate competency, the routine use of conflict analysis is **very low (1.75)**, often occurring only once a year.

4. Key Constraints Hindering Duty Bearers

Systemic bottlenecks prevent duty bearers from translating their knowledge into effective services:

- a) **Resource Deficits:** Severe shortages of **trained personnel** and inadequate budget allocations.
- b) **Policy Gaps:** A perceived **laxity in enforcement** and a "low-to-moderate" rating for the adequacy of existing national protection policies (2.75/5).
- c) **Operational Barriers:** Weak **referral mechanisms**, poor inter-agency coordination, and geographic remoteness (especially in ASAL regions).
- d) **Socio-Cultural Conflicts:** Deeply held religious and cultural beliefs frequently conflict with statutory child protection obligations, leading to the use of **informal "Kangaroo courts"**

3.3 Functionality and Effectiveness of Child Protection, SRHR, Peacebuilding, Environmental Governance, and Referral Systems

This section assesses how existing systems and institutional structures operate, including their accessibility, coordination, responsiveness, service delivery, referral pathways, and effectiveness in safeguarding children's rights.

3.3.1 Functionality and Effectiveness of Child Protection

The baseline findings for the Functionality and Effectiveness of Child Protection reveal a system that is operational but currently hindered by low-to-moderate adequacy and significant systemic gaps. While a diverse mix of protection structures exists, their impact is limited by resource constraints and a disconnect between state duty-bearers and local communities.

Performance Dashboard: System Effectiveness

The study utilized a 5-point scale (1 lowest, 5 highest) to assess various dimensions of the protection landscape. Scores indicate a low perception of state-led service quality:

Indicator	Mean Score (out of 5)	Perceived Status
Adequacy of national child protection services	2.50	Low
Authorities addressing system weaknesses	2.50	Low
Adequacy of national child protection policies	2.75	Low-to-Moderate
Impact of CSO collaboration	2.75	Low-to-Moderate
Government prioritization of child protection	3.25	Moderate
Local community actor collaboration	3.50	Moderate

The Protection Ecosystem

The current landscape is a hybrid of formal statutory bodies and informal grassroots networks:

- a) Statutory Mechanisms: County Advisory Councils (CACs), Gender and Child Protection Working Groups, and the Department of Children's Services.
- b) Community-Led Structures: Child Protection Committees (a universal mechanism), Nyumba Kumi units, and Community Health Promoters (CHPs).

- c) Child-Led Platforms: Kenya Children Assemblies (KCAs) and school-based clubs where children identify challenges and influence policy dialogue.

Critical Systemic Constraints

The effectiveness of these systems is currently undermined by several key bottlenecks:

- a) Resource Deficits: Severe shortages of trained personnel and inadequate budget allocations at both national and county levels.
- b) Coordination Gaps: Weak alignment between national and county governments, fragmented case management, and poor data sharing.
- c) Infrastructure Barriers: Geographic remoteness, particularly in Arid and Semi-Arid Lands (ASAL) like Garissa and Marsabit, restricts service reach.
- d) Socio-Cultural Norms: Entrenched cultural beliefs frequently lead to the use of informal "Kangaroo courts" or "Maslah" systems, which often suppress formal reporting of violations.
- e) Accountability Gaps: There is a perceived laxity in policy enforcement, and duty-bearers report a low-to-moderate level of responsiveness (2.75/5) in addressing existing policy gaps

3.3.2 Functionality and Effectiveness of SRHR

The baseline status of the Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR) system reveals high foundational knowledge among children and high advocacy confidence among staff, but the actual functionality of youth-friendly services is currently rated as limited and emerging.

SRHR System Performance Scorecard

The following values (on a 1–5 scale) illustrate the gap between the high confidence of duty-bearers and the moderate safety felt by children within the system:

- a) 4.2 — Staff Confidence: To develop and support SRHR education for adolescents.
- b) 4.1 — Staff Confidence: To collaborate with health providers for youth-friendly services.

- c) 3.9 — Child Confidence: To share SRHR knowledge with peers and family.
- d) 3.3 — Child Safety: Perception of safety when exercising and discussing SRHR in dialogue spaces.
- e) 2.75 — Life Skills Adequacy: The perceived reach and availability of life skills training for girls

Core Functionality & Access

The sources highlight a system that has established pathways but lacks consistent implementation across all counties:

- a) Service Awareness: 90% of children surveyed know exactly where to find SRHR and maternal health services, showing strong awareness of the physical infrastructure.
- b) Adolescent-Friendly Mechanisms: Existing "youth-friendly" efforts include Adolescent Corners, "Binti kwa Binti" forums for young mothers, and school-based child rights clubs.
- c) Referral Pathways: EACHRights currently supports the system by linking young mothers to health facilities for antenatal care, STI screening, and contraceptives.
- d) Policy Support: The organization advocates for the implementation of school re-entry policies for adolescent mothers to ensure health issues do not end their education

Systemic Effectiveness Gaps

Despite the high awareness, several barriers prevent the system from being fully effective:

- a) County-Specific Vulnerabilities: Homa Bay, Kwale, and Migori are specifically identified as having high rates of adolescent pregnancy and school dropout due to limited access to friendly services.
- b) Emerging Peer Support: Peer education—where girls support each other—is described as being in an early, "limited" stage and has not yet been implemented in all current project portfolios.
- c) Cultural "Shyness": Deeply entrenched cultural taboos make it "very hard" for children to discuss body changes or romantic relationships with parents, creating a communication barrier that formal services have yet to bridge.
- d) Variable Safe Spaces: While safe spaces exist, their presence is not uniform; for example, some current projects lack dedicated safe dialogue components for girls.

Organizational Capacity for System Strengthening

The sources indicate that the framework for improvement is already in place. EACHRights staff possess high confidence in collaborating with health providers (4.1/5) and developing education programs (4.2/5). The baseline suggests that future efforts will focus on institutionalizing these "emerging" approaches—such as peer-to-peer education and digital engagement—to move the system from moderate to high effectiveness.

3.3.3 Functionality and Effectiveness of Peacebuilding

The Functionality and Effectiveness of Peacebuilding at the baseline stage is an emerging priority, particularly vital for conflict-prone regions like Marsabit. While staff possess a solid theoretical foundation in core concepts, there is a significant "implementation gap" where these skills are not yet routinely applied in the field.

The Knowledge-Action Gap

Staff competency (knowledge) remains consistently higher than the frequency of actual application in current projects:

Peacebuilding Indicator	Knowledge/Competency (Mean)	Routine Practice (Mean)
Conflict Analysis	3.50 (Moderate)	1.75 (Very Low)
Non-Violent Communication	3.50 (Moderate)	2.25 (Low)
Conflict Sensitivity	3.00 (Moderate)	2.25 (Low)
Trauma-Informed Practice	2.75 (Low-Moderate)	2.00 (Low)

Peacebuilding Framework & Mechanisms

Current efforts focus on community-led structures and dialogue platforms:

- a) Peace Committees: Dedicated community-level forums utilized for conflict mitigation and social cohesion discussions.
- b) Multi-Stakeholder Dialogues: Engagement of children, families, religious leaders, and local authorities to foster community ownership of rights.

- c) Child-Led Resolution: Children are emerging as active participants, reporting involvement in resolving youth conflicts and community peacebuilding.
- d) Dialogue Readiness: Organizational confidence in using a dialogue approach to address sensitive issues is rated at 3.25/5.

Key Systemic Vulnerabilities

- a) High-Risk Contexts: Marsabit is specifically impacted by recurrent inter-community conflict, insecurity, and displacement, which weaken social cohesion and interrupt education.
- b) Low Routine Integration: There is a "very low routine integration" of formal conflict analysis, with the majority of staff engaging in it only once a year.
- c) Trauma Readiness Gap: A "critical opportunity" exists to standardize trauma-informed principles, as current readiness is low (2.75/5) despite high exposure to SGBV and conflict-related trauma.
- d) Climate & Stress: Recurrent droughts in Garissa and Marsabit exacerbate household stress and poverty, which can trigger negative coping mechanisms and community tensions

3.3.4 Functionality and Effectiveness of Environmental Governance

The baseline status of Environmental Governance within the Safer Futures Project reveals an emerging thematic area where institutional knowledge is solid regarding social safeguards but faces a significant technical gap in specialized environmental child rights analysis. While the project aims to foster climate-resilient communities, the current governance framework is in a foundational stage of development.

Institutional Readiness Scorecard

The study assessed EACHRights staff's confidence in integrating various cross-cutting themes into environmental assessments (on a 5-point scale). The results highlight a strong capability in social-environmental intersections but low technical readiness:

Indicator	Mean Score (out of 5)	Perceived Status
Analyzing gender equality in environmental assessments	3.75	High
Applying "Do No Harm" principles in environmental contexts	3.50	Moderate-to-High
Integrating conflict sensitivity into environmental work	3.25	Moderate
Technical analysis of child-climate impacts	2.50	Low-to-Moderate

Contextual Environmental Realities

Environmental governance is critical because climate stressors directly undermine child protection in the target counties, particularly in Garissa and Marsabit:

- a) Persistent Shocks: Recurrent droughts, climate variability, and environmental degradation exacerbate poverty and food insecurity.
- b) Disproportionate Vulnerability: These stressors lead to negative coping mechanisms that specifically affect girls, children with disabilities, and marginalized communities.
- c) Child-Prioritized Concern: Children themselves, through Children Assemblies, identified climate-related concerns as one of the most pressing threats to their wellbeing.

Governance Mechanisms & Strengths

EACHRights utilizes established organizational programs to drive environmental stewardship:

- a) Dedicated Programs: The organization has a dedicated Environment and Climate Justice program that serves as a core pillar of its advocacy.
- b) Social Safeguards: The team demonstrates a robust foundational understanding of risk-mitigation and safeguard principles ("Do No Harm") when designing environmental activities.
- c) Intersectional Analysis: There is a strong capacity to examine how gender dynamics and environmental impacts intersect, providing a solid basis for gender-responsive climate activities.

Critical Gaps & Challenges

The effectiveness of environmental governance is currently hampered by several technical and structural barriers:

- a) **Technical Knowledge Gap:** 75% of staff reported "Very little" confidence in the technical familiarity required for environmental child rights analysis.
- b) **Resource and Infrastructure Constraints:** Geographic remoteness and poor infrastructure, especially in Arid and Semi-Arid Lands (ASAL), severely restrict the execution of environmental governance initiatives.
- c) **Operational Integration:** While staff analyze political and social dynamics before project rollout, there is a clear need to institutionalize conflict-sensitive methodologies more consistently into environmental work.
- d) **Funding and Capacity:** Limited financial resources and technical capacity among local community groups hinder the sustained management of environmental initiatives

3.3.5 Functionality and Effectiveness of Referral Systems

The baseline status of **Referral Systems** within the project counties indicates a framework that is present but currently **fragmented and under-resourced**. While multi-sectoral networks exist to link children to services, systemic bottlenecks often lead to children "falling through the gaps" during the initial stages of reporting and transition.

System Performance & Risk Assessment

The effectiveness of the national identification, reporting, and referral mechanism is largely perceived as **Average to Poor** by duty-bearers, with significant risks identified at the point of entry into the system:

- a) **System Rating:** Most duty-bearers rate the current national referral mechanism as **3 (Average)** or **2 (Poor)**.
- b) **The "Leakage" Point:** The **Reporting and Referral stage** is identified as the most critical point where children are at the highest risk of falling through the system and failing to receive follow-up care.
- c) **CSO Impact:** While CSOs work to strengthen these networks, their overall perceived impact on the efficacy of these collaborations is rated at a low-to-moderate **2.75 out of 5**.

The Referral Architecture

The referral ecosystem relies on a mix of community-based actors and formal institutions:

- a) **Grassroots Links:** Community Health Promoters (CHPs/CHVs), Child Protection Champions, and school-based child rights clubs act as the primary "eyes and ears" for identifying cases.
- b) **Specialized Pathways:** EACHRights has established specific referral pathways for **psychosocial support** and **SRHR services**, linking survivors of FGM, child marriage, and SGBV to health facilities and legal aid.
- c) **Collaborative Forums:** Multi-stakeholder forums and Gender Technical Working Groups serve as the strategic hubs for coordinating these referrals at the county level.

Primary Obstacles to Effectiveness

Several structural and operational factors hinder the seamless movement of cases through the referral chain:

- a) **Fragmented Coordination:** There is a lack of unified case management and poor data sharing between national and county governments.
- b) **Resource Depletion: Acute shortages of trained personnel** and inadequate budget allocations for transport make case follow-ups nearly impossible in remote areas.
- c) **Service Gaps:** A critical lack of **safe houses and rescue centers** means that even when a child is referred, there may be no safe place for them to go.
- d) **Socio-Cultural Interference:** The use of "**Kangaroo courts**" and the "**Maslah**" **system** often diverts cases away from formal referral pathways, leading to settlements that do not prioritize the child's rights.

Emerging Opportunities

Despite these challenges, there are foundational strengths to build upon:

- a) **Institutional Readiness:** EACHRights possesses a **high level of confidence (4.0/5)** in child-rights advocacy, providing a strong base to lobby for better-integrated systems.

- b) **Integrated Initiatives:** New programs like "**Inua Jamii**" and "**Caring Forms**" are being implemented by ministries to strengthen social protection and staffing.
- c) **Digital Innovation:** Collaboration with **Mtoto News**, an organisation specialising in child participation and digital engagement, alongside the use of toll-free reporting lines in schools, provides modern and accessible mechanisms through which children can safely access and enter the referral system.

3.4 Enabling and Constraining Factors Influencing the Realization of Children's Rights

This section analyses the social, cultural, institutional, governance, environmental, gender, and conflict-related factors that either facilitate or hinder child protection, meaningful participation, access to services, peacebuilding, and achievement of the programme outcomes.

3.4.1 Enabling factors influencing realization of children rights

Based on the sources, the following key enabling factors influence the realization of child protection, participation, and the overall achievement of project outcomes:

1. Strong Legal and Institutional Frameworks

The project is firmly anchored in international and national legal instruments, including the **United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC)**, the **African Charter on the Rights and Welfare of the Child**, and **Kenya's Children Act, 2022**. These frameworks provide a legitimate basis for advocacy and system strengthening, while internal organizational tools—such as **child safeguarding policies**, codes of conduct, and informed consent procedures—ensure that rights-based interventions are implemented safely and ethically.

2. Established Multi-Stakeholder Collaboration Platforms

The existence of **coordinated platforms** at both the county and national levels facilitates unified responses to child rights violations. These include **Gender and Child Protection Technical Working Groups**, County Children Advisory Councils, and national networks like the **Kenya Stakeholders Coalition on the Universal Periodic Review (UPR)**. Such collaborations allow for joint advocacy, resource mobilization, and the strengthening of referral networks across government departments and civil society.

3. Structured and Meaningful Child Participation Mechanisms

A critical enabling factor is the availability of formal platforms that move child engagement beyond mere consultation toward leadership and decision-making. The **Kenya Children Assemblies (KCAs)** serve as the primary vehicle for this, enabling children to articulate challenges and influence policy dialogue. These are complemented by **school-based child rights clubs** and collaboration with **Mtoto News**, an organisation that supports child participation, advocacy and digital engagement, thereby providing additional inclusive opportunities for children to express their views and advocate for their own protection.

4. High Advocacy Capacity and Evidence-Based Programming

The sources highlight a **high level of institutional confidence in child-rights advocacy** (rated 4.0 out of 5), which provides a solid foundation for influencing duty-bearers. This is reinforced by a strong routine of conducting **child rights situation analyses** (reported by 75% of staff), ensuring that interventions are informed by current evidence. Furthermore, the application of established participation models, such as the **Lundy Model**, helps maintain high standards for ethical child engagement.

5. Engagement with Strategic Community and "Moral" Duty-Bearers

Involving **religious leaders, traditional elders, and local authorities** is an essential factor in shifting harmful social norms and promoting peacebuilding. Staff report a **very high level of confidence in raising awareness about harmful norms** (4.25 out of 5), which is crucial for addressing entrenched issues like FGM and child marriage. By recognizing these figures as "moral duty-bearers," the project can facilitate transformative community dialogues that foster social cohesion and long-term behavioral change

3.4.2 Hindering factors to child protection

The baseline study identifies primary **hindering factors** that obstruct the realization of child rights and the effectiveness of protection, participation, and SRHR systems across the target counties.

1. Deeply Entrenched Socio-Cultural Norms

Harmful practices such as **FGM, child marriage, and child labour** are driven by persistent social and religious beliefs that are often prioritized over

statutory laws. These norms are primarily reinforced by older generations and community decision-makers. Furthermore, the continued use of informal "**Kangaroo courts**" or "**Maslah**" **systems** to resolve violations suppresses formal reporting and denies children legal justice.

2. Severe Resource and Infrastructure Constraints

A critical lack of **financial, technical, and human resources** severely limits the operational capacity of child protection systems. This includes:

- a) **Personnel Shortages:** Acute lack of trained child protection and health professionals.
- b) **Geographical Barriers:** The vastness and remoteness of Arid and Semi-Arid Lands (ASAL), coupled with **poor road infrastructure**, make reaching vulnerable children and following up on cases extremely difficult.

3. Institutional Coordination and Policy Gaps

While laws exist, the "Functionality and Effectiveness" of the system is hindered by:

- a) **Weak Inter-agency Coordination:** Fragmented referral systems and poor data sharing between national and county governments.
- b) **Enforcement Laxity:** A perceived lack of political will to finalize or implement localized policies (like anti-FGM or gender policies) and a general **laxity in law enforcement**.
- c) **Systemic "Leaks":** The **reporting and referral stage** is identified as the point where children are at the highest risk of falling through the system.

4. Barriers to Meaningful Child Participation

Children face significant hurdles when trying to voice their concerns or influence decisions:

- a) **Safety and Trust:** Fear of **victimization, stigmatization**, and a lack of confidential reporting channels.
- b) **Adult Disbelief:** A disconnect where duty-bearers often **do not believe or listen to children** because they are "presumed to be not able to raise issues".

- c) **Information Gaps:** Low community awareness regarding available formal reporting pathways and a lack of accessible platforms for engagement.

5. Complex Contextual Vulnerabilities (The "Triple Threat")

Recurring external shocks exacerbate existing protection risks and trigger negative coping mechanisms:

- a) **Climate Shocks:** Frequent **droughts and environmental degradation** drive households toward child marriage or child labour as survival strategies.
- b) **Insecurity:** Recurrent **inter-community conflicts** and displacement, particularly in Marsabit, interrupt education and weaken social cohesion.
- c) **Economic Stress:** Pervasive **poverty and food insecurity** remain foundational drivers that make children—especially girls and those with disabilities—more vulnerable to exploitation

3.5 Baseline Programme Indicators and Outcome Progress Markers

This section presents the baseline values for the project's key performance indicators and Outcome Mapping progress markers, providing benchmarks against which programme performance, behavioural change, and institutional improvements will be measured during routine monitoring, the midterm review, and the endline evaluation.

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1. Outcome 1: Children's Engagement in Governance and Protection

Children in Marsabit and Garissa are actively engaged in child protection issues and governance processes.

Progress Marker / Indicator	Baseline Value (January 2026)	Status
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PM 2.1:1 Children speaking up and advocating for their rights	100%	High
IN 2.1:1 Support/coaching received by children to act as change agents	4.4 / 5.0	High
PM 2.1:3 Children leading or initiating community development activities	90%	High
Indicator Children's confidence to lead community activities	4.1 / 5.0	High
PM 2.1:2 Duty Bearers creating space for children's participation	90%	High
Indicator Children's perception of adult support for their platforms	3.4 / 5.0	Moderate
Indicator Children's perception of duty-bearers listening and supporting	3.4 / 5.0	Moderate

2. Outcome 2: Effective Child Protection and SRHR Systems

Communities contribute to effective protection mechanisms, improved referral pathways, and access to youth-friendly SRHR services.

A. System Functionality and Policy Environment

Indicator / Progress Marker	Baseline Value	Status
Indicator Adequacy of national child protection services	2.50 / 5.0	Low
Indicator Authorities addressing weaknesses in protection services	2.50 / 5.0	Low
Indicator Government prioritization of child protection	3.25 / 5.0	Moderate
Indicator Adequacy of national child protection policies	2.75 / 5.0	Low-Moderate
PM 4.2:1 Duty-bearers acknowledging shortcomings in rights provision	3.00 / 5.0	Moderate
PM 4.1:1 Local actors collaborating on protection mechanisms	3.50 / 5.0	Moderate
PM 4.1:2 Actors engaging in Multi-Stakeholder Dialogues (MSDs)	3.00 / 5.0	Occasional
PM 4.1:4 CSOs building forums and coalitions for collective action	3.25 / 5.0	Moderate

Indicator Impact of inter-organizational CSO collaboration	2.75 / 5.0	Low-Moderate
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B. Prevalence of Harmful Practices (PM 3.2:1 & PM 3.2:2)

Community members' perception of the prevalence of common threats (Scale 1–5):

- a) **Female Genital Mutilation (FGM): 4.50** (Highly Prevalent).
- b) **Child Labour: 4.33** (Highly Prevalent).
- c) **Child Marriage: 4.25** (Highly Prevalent).
- d) **Gender-Based Violence (GBV): 4.25** (Highly Prevalent).
- e) **Child Trafficking: 3.50** (Moderately Prevalent).

C. SRHR and Safe Spaces (PM 2.2:1)

SRHR Indicator	Baseline Value	Status
Indicator Children's knowledge of SRHR rights and their bodies	4.2 / 5.0	High
Indicator Children's safety to discuss SRHR in dialogue spaces	3.3 / 5.0	Moderate
Indicator Confidence of girls to share SRHR knowledge with peers	3.9 / 5.0	High
Indicator Status/availability of girls' life skills training	2.75 / 5.0	Inadequate

3. Outcome 3: Peacebuilding and Social Cohesion

Communities contribute to effective peace structures and child-sensitive conflict resolution.

Peacebuilding Marker / Indicator	Baseline Value	Status
Indicator Staff competency in Conflict Analysis	3.50 / 5.0	Moderate
Indicator Frequency of conducting formal Conflict Analysis	1.75 / 5.0	Very Low

Indicator Staff competency in Non-Violent Communication (NVC)	3.50 / 5.0	Moderate
Indicator Frequency of utilizing NVC in the field	2.25 / 5.0	Low-Moderate
Indicator Staff competency in Trauma-Informed Implementation	2.75 / 5.0	Low-Moderate
Indicator Frequency of applying Trauma-Informed principles	2.00 / 5.0	Low

4. Outcome 4: Environmental Resilience

Communities contribute to environmental governance and climate-resilient environments.

Environmental Resilience Indicator	Baseline Value	Status
Indicator Confidence: Gender equality in environmental assessments	3.75 / 5.0	High
Indicator Confidence: "Do No Harm" in environmental contexts	3.50 / 5.0	Moderate-High
Indicator Confidence: Technical child-climate impact analysis	2.50 / 5.0	Low-Moderate
Indicator Confidence: Conflict sensitivity in environmental assessments	3.25 / 5.0	Moderate

5. Institutional and Partner Capacity Markers

EACHRights and partner organizational strengths (PM 1.1 & PM 1.2).

- a) **Routine Child Rights Situation Analysis: 75%** of staff conduct this regularly.
- b) **Confidence in Child Rights Advocacy: 4.0 / 5.0** (High institutional capacity).
- c) **Confidence in Raising Awareness on Harmful Norms: 4.25 / 5.0** (High).
- d) **Confidence in Child Participation Self-Assessment: 3.50 / 5.0** (Moderate-High).
- e) **Confidence in Using Dialogue for Sensitive Issues: 3.25 / 5.0** (Moderate).

f) **Religious Literacy (Scale 1–5): 3.00** (Moderate/Somewhat).

4.0 SUMMARY, CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This section synthesizes the key findings and presents practical recommendations to strengthen programme implementation, policy advocacy, institutional coordination, community engagement, organizational learning, and adaptive management throughout the implementation period of the **Safer Futures (Watoto Wetu Phase IV)** project.

4.1 Summary of key findings

The January 2026 baseline assessment reveals a complex landscape where high individual awareness and strong organizational advocacy foundations are contrasted by systemic service gaps and deeply entrenched social norms.

1. **Status of Child Protection Systems:** The perceived adequacy of national child protection services is **low (2.50 out of 5)**, with authorities rated equally low in addressing existing system weaknesses. The system is undermined by **acute shortages of trained personnel**, inadequate budget allocations, and a disconnect between state duty-bearers and local communities.
2. **Prevalence of Harmful Practices:** Harmful practices remain **highly prevalent** across the target counties. Partner organizations rated **Female Genital Mutilation (FGM)** (4.50), **child labour** (4.33), and **child marriage** (4.25) as persistent threats. These practices are primarily reinforced by **older generations and community decision-makers**, often prioritized over statutory laws.
3. **Children's Participation and Advocacy:** There is a robust level of child engagement, with **100% of surveyed children** reporting that they actively speak up for their rights. The **Kenya Children Assemblies (KCAs)** serve as the primary platform for leadership and policy dialogue, particularly in Marsabit and Garissa. However, children still face significant barriers, including **adult disbelief** and a lack of accessible, confidential reporting channels.
4. **Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR):** While children demonstrate **high knowledge of their body rights (4.2 out of 5)**, they feel only **moderately safe (3.3 out of 5)** to discuss these topics in dialogue spaces. Actual access to youth-friendly services and peer education remains **limited and developing**, with cultural taboos making it "very hard" for many children to discuss SRHR with parents.
5. **Peacebuilding and Environmental Resilience:** These are emerging thematic areas showing a **knowledge-action gap**. Staff possess moderate theoretical knowledge of peacebuilding (3.5 out of 5) but integrate formal conflict analysis with **very low frequency (1.75 out of 5)**.

- 5). Similarly, there is a **critical technical gap** in staff confidence regarding environmental child rights analysis (2.5 out of 5).
6. **Institutional Capacity:** EACHRights possesses a **high level of confidence in child-rights advocacy (4.0 out of 5)** and has established comprehensive tools for child participation. This provides a strong foundation for the project, though technical capacity building is required for specialized areas like **trauma-informed implementation** (2.75 out of 5).

4.2 Conclusion

The January 2026 baseline assessment for the **Safer Futures Project** reveals a child protection landscape defined by a stark contrast between **high individual agency** and **low systemic support**. While children across the five target counties demonstrate high levels of confidence and a strong theoretical understanding of their rights, the formal systems designed to protect them—specifically **national child protection services and referral mechanisms**—are currently perceived as systemically inadequate due to resource deficits and poor coordination. The high prevalence of harmful practices such as **FGM, child marriage, and child labour** confirms that deeply entrenched socio-cultural norms remain the primary obstacle to the project's goal of creating safe and inclusive environments.

As the project moves into full implementation for the 2026–2028 period, a critical priority will be bridging the "**knowledge-action gap**" identified in newer thematic areas such as peacebuilding and environmental resilience. Although staff possess a solid foundational knowledge, the routine application of conflict analysis and technical climate assessments remains low. By leveraging EACHRights' **high institutional advocacy capacity** (rated 4.0 out of 5) and strengthening existing multi-stakeholder platforms, the project is well-positioned to translate individual rights awareness into **meaningful, child-led governance** and improved service delivery.

Ultimately, these baseline findings provide more than just benchmarks; they offer a robust, **evidence-based roadmap for adaptive management**. By addressing the disconnect between duty-bearers and community-led structures, the project can ensure that the communities of Garissa, Marsabit, Homa Bay, Kwale, and Migori become truly resilient environments where children are not only aware of their rights but are actively protected by accountable systems.

4.3 Practical recommendations

4.3.1 practical recommendations to strengthen programme implementation

1. Institutionalize Routine Conflict-Sensitive and Peacebuilding Practices:

The project should transition from ad-hoc analysis to a mandatory, periodic (e.g., quarterly) conflict-sensitivity review integrated into the project cycle. This should include standardized training in **Non-Violent Communication (NVC)** to move staff from theoretical awareness to confident field execution during community dialogues in conflict-prone areas like Marsabit.

2. Close Technical Gaps in Environmental Child Rights and Trauma-Informed Care.

Prioritize the development of a **technical toolkit and training modules** that specifically bridge these gaps. This should focus on linking climate adaptation strategies directly to child protection outcomes and standardizing **trauma-informed protocols**—such as safeguarding, strict confidentiality, and empathetic engagement—across all project portfolios to ensure consistent service delivery regardless of the specific program focus.

3. Enhance Child-Led Reporting Systems and Adult Responsiveness:

Although children are highly active in advocacy, they report that **"victimization," "lack of trust," and "inefficient channels"** remain major barriers to reporting violations. Strengthen reporting pathways by establishing child-friendly, anonymous feedback loops (such as school-based suggestion boxes and digital platforms) and conduct **"Adult Buy-In" workshops** for duty-bearers. These workshops should specifically train parents and officials to "believe and support" children's voices, addressing the disconnect that currently prevents children from feeling safe when sharing their views with local authorities

4.3.2 Practical recommendations to strengthen policy advocacy

4. Prioritize the Finalization of Pending County and National Policies.

The assessment highlights that critical instruments, such as the **Garissa Gender and Anti-FGM policies** and the **National Strategic Framework** for preventing harmful practices, are currently "works in progress" or awaiting adoption. Leverage EACHRights' high confidence in advocacy (**4.0 out of 5**)

to facilitate direct, multi-stakeholder negotiation forums. These should specifically target the identified "lack of political will" in County Assemblies and executive ministries to move these policies from draft stages to full adoption and budgeting.

5. Bridge the "Evidence Gap" Using Localized, Disaggregated Data. A primary barrier for policy-makers is the **lack of disaggregated data**, which hinders evidence-based decision-making and budget allocation. Utilize the existing organizational habit of conducting **Child Rights Situation Analyses** (practiced by 75% of staff) to produce county-specific policy briefs. These briefs should provide duty-bearers with the technical data needed to justify resource allocations for child protection and SRHR services, effectively translating international human rights commitments into local implementation matrices.

6. Strengthen Accountability via National and Regional Advocacy Networks. EACHRights currently occupies strategic positions in influential networks, such as serving as the **Secretariat for the UPR Stakeholders Coalition** and participating in **Girls Not Brides Kenya**. Use these established platforms to routinely monitor and report on the "low" perceived state responsiveness to child rights weaknesses (**2.50 out of 5**). By integrating county-level baseline findings into national reporting mechanisms, the project can increase pressure on duty-bearers to address systemic "leakage points"—particularly in the reporting and referral stages where children are most at risk of falling through the system.

4.3.3 Practical recommendations to strengthen institutional coordination

7. Standardize and Digitalize Referral Protocols. The baseline identified **poor data sharing** and **fragmented case management** as primary barriers to effective protection. Develop and institutionalize a **Unified Referral Directory and Case Tracking Tool** that links community-level actors (CHPs, teachers) directly with statutory bodies (DCS, police). This should move beyond ad-hoc referrals to a synchronized system that tracks a child's progress through screening, assessment, and final service delivery to prevent "system leakage".

8. Institutionalize the "Inclusion of Moral Duty-Bearers." Stakeholder engagement is currently **not uniform**, with traditional and religious leaders—who are the primary "lawmakers" at the community level—often operating outside formal coordination forums. Regularize the participation of **religious and traditional councils** (e.g., the Gada or Yaa) within County Children

Advisory Councils and Technical Working Groups. By moving these actors from the periphery into fixed-calendar strategic meetings, the project can ensure that formal policies, such as the **Marsabit Integrated Child Policy**, have the necessary cultural legitimacy to be enforced.

9. Bridge the Intergovernmental "Policy-to-Action" Gap. There is a noted **disconnect** between high-level international commitments (like the UPR) and practical county-level execution, often due to a lack of technical knowledge and alignment between National and County governments. Establish a **"Policy Implementation Task Force"** specifically tasked with finalizing the Garissa Anti-FGM and Gender policies. This task force should focus on aligning county-specific implementation matrices with national budget cycles, ensuring that "political will" is translated into **dedicated budget lines** for children's services rather than remaining as draft instruments.

4.3.4 Practical recommendations to strengthen community engagement

10. Transform Traditional and Religious Leaders into "Champions of Change." In counties like Marsabit, traditional councils of elders (such as the **Yaa, Nabo, and Gada**) are the primary lawmakers at the community level and the chief custodians of culture. Leverage the high institutional confidence in raising awareness on harmful norms (**4.25 out of 5**) to implement **sustained, culturally sensitive dialogues** with these specific elders. The goal is to shift their role from perpetuating retrogressive practices like FGM and child marriage to becoming proactive advocates for the **Marsabit Integrated Child Policy** and national anti-FGM laws.

11. Reconstruct Trust by Strengthening Grassroots "Nyumba Kumi" and Protection Committees.

A significant barrier to community engagement is the **strained collaboration** between state officials and local communities, which leads to low awareness of formal reporting pathways. Empower existing grassroots structures—specifically **Child Protection Committees, Nyumba Kumi administrative units, and Community Health Promoters (CHPs)**—to serve as the primary link between the community and the state. By providing these actors with technical training and resources for case follow-ups, the project can reduce community reliance on informal **"Kangaroo courts"** that often fail to prioritize the child's rights.

12. Facilitate Intergenerational Dialogues to Bridge the "Communication Gap."

The baseline highlights a clear generational divide: while older generations often uphold FGM and early marriage as essential for community honor, **youth and children** are increasingly questioning these norms. Furthermore, children report that "cultural shyness" makes it "very hard" to discuss body changes or rights with parents. Use the **Kenya Children Assemblies (KCA)** and school-based clubs to host structured **intergenerational forums**. These platforms should utilize participatory learning methodologies (such as songs, storytelling, and games) to enable children to safely voice their concerns to parents and elders, thereby breaking down cultural taboos and fostering a more supportive household environment for child rights.

4.3.5 Practical recommendations to strengthen organizational learning, and adaptive management

13. Institutionalize Standardized Reflective Learning and Self-Assessment. While staff report moderately high confidence (3.5/5) in self-assessing their work, there is a recognized need for more structured "reflective learning approaches". Integrate "**Outcome Harvesting**" and annual reflection sessions into the project calendar to identify unintended results and successes. This should be supported by standardized capacity building on **participatory monitoring tools**, ensuring that all staff—not just 75%—regularly conduct and utilize child rights situation analyses to guide their work.

14. Systematize Child-Friendly Feedback for Real-Time Adjustments. The organization has various feedback channels (suggestion boxes, surveys, and meetings), but their application is not yet uniform across all stakeholders. Establish a centralized "**Learning and Feedback Registry**" where data from child-friendly sessions and beneficiary satisfaction surveys is systematically documented and analyzed. This evidence should be presented during quarterly management meetings to trigger "adaptive management" shifts in project strategy, ensuring that children's lived experiences directly inform project pivots.

15. Expand "Communities of Practice" for Multi-County Peer Learning. The baseline highlights the value of the **CORD Community of Practice approach**, which facilitates the exchange of technical expertise and best practices. Create structured **Peer Learning Forums** that link staff and CSO partners across the five counties (Garissa, Marsabit, Homa Bay, Kwale, and Migori) to share "most significant change stories" and technical evidence. These forums should specifically focus on newer thematic areas—such as **trauma-informed implementation and environmental child rights**—to close the identified knowledge gaps across the team.

5.0 APPENDICES

5.1 Updated Results matrix

Intervention Outcomes	Intervention specific Progress Markers/Indicators	Means of Verification	Main Strategies	Contribution to Safer Futures Programme	Target Baseline population	Proposed end of project Target	Verified Baseline Value	Supporting Evidence	Performance Judge ment	Key enabling/Constraining factors
				(Progress Markers, number)						
Children in Marsabit and Garissa are actively engaged in Child Protection issues	Children's voices in Garissa and Marsabit incorporated during policy development on issues that affect them.	No. of laws and policies reviewed with children's input.	Support Children Assemblies and Child rights clubs where children can increase their knowledge on human rights and become positive agents of change.	PM2.1:1 Children are speaking up and advocating for their rights from duty bearers	children and youth	Maintain 100% of targeted children actively speaking up and advocating for their rights from duty bearers through 2028	100% advocacy rate; moderate 3.4/5.0. Children's confidence that duty-bearers actually listen, believe, and support their voices	KII and FGD responses	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: Kenya Children Assemblies (KCAs) give children a structured vehicle to raise issues. Constraining: a "credibility gap" persists - children's confidence that duty-bearers actually listen/believe/support them is only moderate (3.4/5.0); "adult disbelief" and informal "Kangaroo courts" bypass children's formal input.

	10 Children Assemblies in Garissa and Marsabit re-established and supported as platforms for child participation in decision making.	Copies of petitions submitted by children on policy issues.	Empower children and youth to lead advocacy campaigns at national, sub-national and community levels.	IN2.1:1 Number of children supported (trained, coached, etc.) to act as agents of change on child rights	Children and youth	Train and support a minimum of 1,120 children to act as agents of change on child rights by 2028, increasing the support satisfaction score from 4.4 to 5.0 out of 5.0	4.4 / 5.0 (High) – children's rating of support/coaching received to act as change agents	KII and FGD responses from children and youth; Des Report baseline indicator table (Section 3.5, p.38)	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: Kenya Children Assemblies (KCAs) already serve as a coaching/mentoring vehicle for children. Constraining: support is not yet institutionalised into a standardised coaching curriculum across all target counties.
	10 Children Assemblies in Garissa and Marsabit raising awareness and/or capacity of other children about child rights issues (peer-to-peer support).	No. of Children Assemblies re-established and functional.	Strengthen platforms for child participation.	IN2.1:2 Number of child/youth platforms (clubs, forums, assemblies) established and functional / supported (if already functioning)	Children and youth	10 Children Assemblies in Garissa and Marsabit re-established and supported as platforms for child participation in	0 Children Assemblies re-established under this project to date (baseline, Jan 2026); Kenya Children Assemblies (KCAs) already exist informally as the primary	Document reviews; KII and FGD responses from children and youth	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: existing KCA structures provide a ready platform to build on. Constraining: assemblies are not yet formally re-established/functional under the project framework in all 10 target sites.

						decision making.	child-participation platform in Garissa and Marsabit			
	% of children reporting that their views are taken seriously by the Local Government .	No. of children trained on child rights issues.		PM2.1:2 Duty Bearers (legal and moral) are creating space for children's participation in decision-making in their community	Children and youth	Increase to 100% the proportion of legal and moral duty bearers creating space for children's participation in decision-making by 2028, raising children's perception of adult support from 3.4 to 5.0 out of	90% – duty bearers creating space for children's participation ; children's perception of adult support 3.4/5.0 (Moderate)	KII and FGD responses from children and youth; KII with legal duty bearers (children officers, teachers) ; Document reviews	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: KCAs used by 82% of officials for policy development; school-based clubs, chief's barazas and the Tamani Youth initiative also create space. Constraining: "credibility gap" - children's perception of duty-bearers listening/supporting is only moderate (3.4/5.0); "adult disbelief" and "Kangaroo courts" bypass children's formal input.

		Lists of children office bearers, Training reports, Reports and videos. Lists of participants.		PM2.1:3 Children are leading/initiating community development activities	Children and youth	Increase to 100% the proportion of children leading or initiating community development activities by 2028, raising their leadership confidence score from 4.1 to 5.0 out of 5.0	90% – children leading/initiating community development activities; confidence to lead 4.1/5.0 (High); 80% participating in community decisions	KII and FGD responses from children and youth; KII with legal duty bearers; Document reviews	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: strong self-efficacy and platforms such as KCAs enable child-led governance, policy and dialogue roles. Constraining: ~20% of children in some samples have not yet participated in formal decision-making; credibility gap with duty-bearers (3.4/5.0).
Local communities contribute towards the realization of effective Child Protection and SRHR	National CSOs actively supporting the implementation of The National Strategy for the Prevention and Response to Harmful	Stakeholders consultation reports.	Training stakeholders on conflict sensitivity and peace building.	PM2.2:1 Duty bearers (legal and moral) are ensuring adequate provision of age appropriate / youth friendly SRHR information and services.	Children, youth, community members, community leaders and duty bearers	Increase to 100% the active provision of age-appropriate, youth-friendly SRHR information and services by legal and moral duty	90% of children know where to access SRHR/maternal health services; staff confidence to develop SRHR education 4.2/5.0; child safety	Survey - FGDs and KIIs with community members, children, youth, community leaders and duty	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: high SRHR knowledge among children (4.2/5.0) and strong staff confidence developing SRHR education/collaborating with health providers (4.1-

systems .	Practices Affecting Children (2025–2030) and Male Engagement programme to end child marriage.					bearers by 2028, raising the perceived adequacy of life skills training from 2.75 to 5.0 out of 5.0	to discuss SRHR 3.3/5.0 (Moderate); girls' life-skills training adequacy 2.75/5.0 (Inadequate)	bearers; Desk review of internal and external project documents		4.2/5.0). Constraining: "cultural shyness" and taboos limit safe discussion of SRHR (3.3/5.0); girls' life-skills training rated inadequate (2.75/5.0); high adolescent pregnancy in Homa Bay, Kwale and Migori.
	Existing CSOs networks in Garissa, Marsabit, Homa Bay, Kwale and Migori are aware of conflict sensitive approached in advocacy and child protection mechanisms	Petitions and Memoranda.	Advocacy campaigns to prevent harmful cultural practices.	PM3.1:3 Traditional and religious actors using their platforms to challenge harmful norms and practices against children.	Community leaders (traditional and religious actors)	Increase to 100% the proportion of traditional and religious actors actively using their platforms to challenge harmful practices against children by 2028,	Leader confidence to raise awareness on harmful norms 4.5/5.0 (High); 100% of leaders view child protection as a collective duty; only 27% (4/15) of religious leaders	KII responses from community members, children, youth and community leaders; Desk review of internal and external	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: universal (100%) agreement that child protection is a shared duty; high leader confidence (4.5/5.0); existing platforms (Yaa, Nabo, Gada councils, mosque/baraza sermons). Constraining: institutional

						raising active platform usage from 27% to 100% and staff religious literacy from 3.0 to 5.0 out of 5.0 .	currently have a distinct awareness-raising role	project documents		"religious literacy" only moderate (3.0/5.0) and just 27% of religious leaders actively use their platforms for awareness-raising; some elders remain "custodians" of harmful norms.
		Copies of Policy drafts, Implementation matrix, budgets developed and approved by the relevant legislative committees/ executive ministries.	Facilitate transformative dialogues.	PM3.2:1 Community members expressing changes in attitude regarding child abuse, violence, and exploitation, (e.g. child labour, child marriage, FGM, GBV, trafficking) particularly against girls.	Community members	Achieve 100% community-wide expression of positive attitude change regarding child abuse, violence, and exploitation by 2028, reducing the perceived baseline prevalence score of harmful	Perceived prevalence of harmful practices (1-5 scale): FGM 4.50, Child Labour 4.33, Child Marriage 4.25, GBV 4.25, Child Trafficking 3.50 (Highly/Moderately Prevalent); 100% of leaders affirm child protection is	KII responses of community members	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: universal (100%) agreement that child protection is a shared responsibility; an emerging generational shift among urban youth and girls questioning harmful norms. Constraining: deeply entrenched socio-cultural norms, "cultural

						practices from an average of 4.17 (including FGM at 4.50 and Child Labour at 4.33) to 1.0 out of 5.0 .	a collective duty			shyness", and informal "Kangaroo courts" that bypass formal justice; older generations remain the main "custodians" of harmful practices.
		Copies of formal policies and approved guidelines adopted, launched and disseminated.	Sensitization through media.	IN3.2:1 People in Local communities, (including traditional and religious actors,) reached with awareness raising regarding risks and behaviours associated with child abuse and gender-based violence.	Community members (including traditional and religious actors)	Reach 100% of targeted local community members and key moral duty-bearers (including traditional and religious actors) with awareness-raising on child abuse and GBV risks by 2028, expanding distinct	0 people reached with awareness-raising under this project to date (baseline, Jan 2026); existing general awareness of child rights is high (4.2/5.0 mean) though behaviour has not yet changed	KII responses of community members ; Document review	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: high existing rights-awareness (4.2/5.0) to build outreach on. Constraining: a "Knowledge-Action Gap" - awareness has not yet translated into behaviour change; harmful practices remain highly prevalent (average 4.33/5.0).

					faith-based awareness platforms from 27% to 100%					
	Local communities in Marsabit including CSO networks, traditional and religious leaders peacefully engaging with duty bearers in the implementation of the Marsabit Child Protection policy and FGM Action Plan.	% change in resources allocated towards end FGM, child marriage and SRH interventions by State agencies.	Treaty monitoring and reporting	PM3.2:2 Community members are reducing negative practices - child abuse, violence, and exploitation, (e.g. child labour, child marriage, FGM, GBV, trafficking) particularly against girls.	Children, youth and community members	Achieve a community-wide reduction in negative practices against children by 2028, lowering the perceived baseline prevalence score of child abuse, violence, and exploitation (including FGM at 4.50 and child labour at 4.33) from an average of 4.33 to	Baseline prevalence of negative practices (1-5): FGM 4.50, Child Labour 4.33, Child Marriage 4.25, GBV 4.25, Child Trafficking 3.50 (average of top 4 = 4.33, Highly Prevalent); 100% agree girls bear the disproportionate burden of protection failures	Surveys - FGDs and KIIs with children, youth and community members	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: 100% of community leaders affirm child protection is a collective duty, a foundation for behaviour change. Constraining: "systemic leakage" at the reporting/referral stage; informal "Kangaroo courts"/"Maslah" systems suppress formal reporting; harmful norms reinforced across generations.

					1.0 out of 5.0					
			Facilitate Multi-stakeholder dialogue forums with duty bearers.	PM4.1:1 Local community actors (CSOs, community actors, and legal duty bearers) are collaborating to build/strengthen relevant (i.e. context and conflict sensitive) community-based child protection mechanisms	Partner organisation, community leaders and duty bearers	Increase to 5.0 out of 5.0 the collaboration rating among local community actors (CSOs, community actors, and legal duty bearers) in building context- and conflict-sensitive child protection mechanisms by 2028, raising the baseline score from	3.50 / 5.0 (Moderate) – local actor collaboration; 100% of cases involve local authorities/ frontline services, but only 50% involve parental support; perceived impact of CSO collaboration 2.75/5.0 (Low-Moderate)	KII responses of Partner Organisation, Community Leaders and Duty bearers; Document reviews	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: Child Protection Committees (CPCs) and Nyumba Kumi units already function as core community-based mechanisms, with 100% local-authority involvement in reported cases. Constraining: low parental involvement (50%); "systemic leakage" at the referral stage; personnel/funding shortages; informal "Kangaroo

					3.50 to 5.0 out				courts"; very low frequency of formal conflict analysis (1.75/5.0).
Local communities in Garissa including CSO networks, traditional and religious leaders peacefully engaging with duty bearers in the finalization and implementation of the Garissa Anti-FGM and Gender policies.		Advocacy campaigns to prevent harmful cultural practices.	IN4.1:1 Number of communities trained on community-based child protection approaches	Community members and community leaders	Train 100% of targeted local communities across the five project counties on community-based child protection approaches by 2028, elevating local collaboration scores from 3.50 to 5.0 out of 5.0.	0 communities trained under this project to date (baseline, Jan 2026); existing informal mechanisms (CPCs, Nyumba Kumi units, school-based clubs) already operate in target counties	KII responses of Partner Organisation, Community Leaders and Duty bearers; Document reviews	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: existing CPC/Nyumba Kumi structures provide an entry point for formal training. Constraining: no formal project training delivered yet; capacity gaps remain among community actors.
			IN4.1:2 Number of community-based CP structures started/supp	Community members and commu	Establish and support 100% of targeted communit	0 new community-based child protection structures started/sup	Document reviews; KII responses of	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: existing informal structures to formalise and strengthen.

			orted by the program.	nity leaders	y-based child protection structures (including Child Protection Committees, Children Assemblies, and Nyumba Kumi units) across the five project counties by 2028, elevating local actor collaboration scores from 3.50 to 5.0 out of 5.0.	ported under this project to date (baseline); existing informal structures (CPCs, Nyumba Kumi units) already present in target counties	Partner Organisation, Community Leaders and Duty bearers		Constraining: structures not yet supported/started under this project; resource constraints limit reach.
Existing CSOs networks peacefully engaging with duty bearers for adequate provision of age appropriate			PM4.1:2 Local community actors (CSOs, community actors, and legal duty bearers) engaging in dialogue (MSDs) to strengthen	Partner organisation, community leaders and duty bearers	Increase to 5.0 out of 5.0 the engagement level of local community actors and duty bearers in Multi-	3.00 / 5.0 (Occasional) – actors engaging in Multi-Stakeholder Dialogues (MSDs)	KII responses of Partner Organisation, Community Leaders and Duty	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: structural framework already exists (Gender and Child Protection Technical Working Groups, County

/ youth friendly SRHR information and services. in Homabay, Kwale and Migori.			effective child protection systems.		Stakeholder Dialogues (MSDs) by 2028, raising the baseline score from 3.00 (occasionally) to 5.0 out of 5.0 .		bearers; Document reviews		Children Advisory Councils). Constraining: engagement is "not yet uniform" and dialogue occurs only "sometimes"; traditional/religious leader involvement varies by site; "accountability gap" - low perceived impact on addressing weaknesses (2.50/5.0).
Enhanced coordination and learning for CSOs for collective advocacy on child protection and SRHR at National level and in Marsabit, Garissa, Kwale, Homabay and Migori.			IN4.1:3 Number of communities where MSDs have been held.	Community members and community leaders	Conduct Multi-Stakeholder Dialogues (MSDs) across 100% of targeted communities in all five project counties by 2028, elevating multi-	0 MSDs held under this project to date (baseline); existing county-level platforms (Technical Working Groups, Advisory Councils) already convene occasionally	Document reviews; KII responses of Partner Organisation, Community Leaders and Duty bearers	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: existing county platforms provide a channel to formalise MSDs. Constraining: no project-led MSDs held yet; frequency of existing dialogue is only

					stakeholder dialogue engagement from an occasional baseline score of 3.00 to 5.0 out of 5.0				"occasional" (3.00/5.0).
			PM4.1:3 local community actors (with support from CSOs) are advocating for child protection systems, and accessible child friendly services, holding duty bearers to account for their provision.	Partner organisation, community leaders and duty bearers	Increase to 100% the proportion of local community actors actively advocating for child protection systems and accessible child-friendly services by 2028, raising accountability capacity from 3.5 to 5.0 out of 5.0 .	73% (11/15) of community leaders actively pushing for better services (High Engagement); institutional confidence in child-rights advocacy 4.0/5.0 (High); capacity to hold duty-bearers to account 3.5/5.0 (Moderate-High)	External and internal document reviews; Survey - KII responses of Partner Organisations, duty bearers and Community Leaders	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: strong grassroots advocacy (73%), often supported externally (e.g. UNICEF, SHOFCE); high institutional confidence in advocacy (4.0/5.0). Constraining: low perceived impact of CSO collaboration (2.75/5.0) and low state responsiveness (2.50/5.0); informal "Kangaroo courts"; shortage of trained personnel.

				PM4.1:4 CSOs are building forums, coalitions and networks for collective action, advocacy, and learning regarding community-based child protection systems	Partner organisation and community leaders	Increase to 5.0 out of 5.0 the capacity score of CSOs building forums, coalitions, and networks for collective action, advocacy, and learning by 2028, raising baseline coalition building from 3.25 to 5.0 out of 5.0 and perceived collaboration impact from 2.75 to 5.0 out of 5.0	3.25 / 5.0 (Moderate) – CSOs building forums/coalitions; perceived impact of inter-organisational CSO collaboration 2.75/5.0 (Low-Moderate)	Document review, surveys (KIIs) of Partner Organisation and Community Leaders	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: active membership in national coalitions (EACHRights is Secretariat for the UPR Kenya Coalition; member of Girls Not Brides Kenya) and county Technical Working Groups. Constraining: resource constraints, weak inter-sectoral coordination and inconsistent policy implementation limit actual impact of these forums.
				IN4.1:4 Number of learning studies on good practice	Partner organisation and CSOs	Publish and disseminate learning studies on	0 learning studies on good-practice models	Document review, surveys (KIIs) of	Baseline benchmark	Enabling: existing CSO networks and coalitions (e.g. UPR Kenya

				models created by the networks.		good practice models created by CSO networks across all five target counties by 2028, raising the perceived impact of CSO collaboration from 2.75 to 5.0 out of 5.0 .	created under this project to date (baseline, Jan 2026)	Partner Organisation and Community Leaders	established	Coalition) provide a platform for future learning studies. Constraining: no studies produced yet; limited resources for structured peer learning and documentation .
				PM4.2:1 Duty bearers (working with local communities and CSOs) recognize/acknowledge shortcomings in the provision of children's legal right to protection (i.e. where they are failing in their legal	Duty bearers	Increase to 5.0 out of 5.0 the extent to which duty bearers recognize and acknowledge shortcomings in fulfilling children's legal right to protection	3.00 / 5.0 (Moderate) – duty-bearers acknowledging shortcomings in rights provision	Survey (KIIIs) - Partner Organisation and Duty bearers; Des Report baseline indicator table (Section 3.5, p.38)	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: most duty-bearers rate the clarity of their legal responsibilities as "a good deal" clear. Constraining: enforcement remains weak due to acute personnel shortages and reliance on informal "Kangaroo courts" that

			responsibilities)		by 2028, raising the baseline score from 3.00 to 5.0 out of 5.0 .				bypass statutory guidelines.
			IN4.2:1 Number of Legal duty bearers reached with awareness/training regarding child protection and community-based child protection approaches.	Legal duty bearers	Reach 100% of targeted legal duty-bearers (including children's officers, law enforcement, judicial officers, and local administrators) across all five project counties with child protection awareness and training by 2028, raising state responsiveness from	0 legal duty bearers reached with awareness/training under this project to date (baseline, Jan 2026)	Survey (KIIs) - Partner Organisation and Duty bearers	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: duty-bearers already anchor their work in Kenya's Children Act (2022) and the Anti-FGM Act. Constraining: an "implementation gap" persists at county level, where draft policies frequently stall before adoption.

					2.50 to 5.0 out of 5.0.				
			PM4.2:2 Legal duty-bearers commit to and implement policy changes to ensure laws - and guidelines/procedures to implement the laws - protect children and ensure the provision of children's rights.	Legal duty bearers	Ensure 100% of targeted legal duty-bearers commit to and implement child protection policy changes by 2028, finalizing pending draft county policies (such as the Garissa Gender and Anti-FGM policies) and raising policy adequacy scores	Adequacy of national child protection policies 2.75/5.0 (Low-Moderate); authorities addressing system weaknesses 2.50/5.0 (Low); impact of CSO collaboration on policy 2.75/5.0 (Low-Moderate); government prioritization of child protection 3.25/5.0 (Moderate); 75% of staff/partners report a	Survey (KII) - Partner Organisation and Duty bearers	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: a "mature" national legal framework (Children Act 2022, Anti-FGM Act) and Marsabit's Integrated Child Policy (2024) already developed. Constraining: an "implementation gap" - draft county policies (e.g. Garissa Anti-FGM and Gender policies) remain stalled, lacking dedicated budget lines; personnel shortages and informal "Kangaroo courts" bypass

						from 2.75 to 5.0 out of 5.0 .	lack of political will to finalize draft policies			statutory guidelines.
Local communities contribute towards effective peace building in Marsabit County.	Peace committees are aware of their responsibilities towards child protection in peace building.	Peace committee reports.	Training stakeholders on conflict sensitivity and peace building.	PM3.2:1 Community members expressing changes in attitude regarding child abuse, violence, and exploitation, (e.g. child labour, child marriage, FGM, GBV, trafficking) particularly against girls.	Community members / Peace Committees	Achieve 100% community-wide expression of positive attitude change regarding child abuse, violence, and exploitation by 2028, reducing the perceived baseline prevalence score of harmful practices from an average of 4.17 (including	Staff competency in Conflict Sensitivity 3.00/5.0 (Moderate), frequency of routine practice 2.25/5.0 (Low-to-Moderate); community perception of harmful-practice prevalence remains high (e.g. FGM 4.50, Child Marriage 4.25 on a 1-5 scale)	KII/FGD with community members and EACHRights staff; Des Report Sections 3.1.3 and 3.1.5 (pp. 35-38)	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: existing Peace Committees serve as community-level forums for conflict mitigation; children already report participating in resolving youth conflicts. Constraining: "very low routine integration" of conflict analysis (1.75/5.0) - most staff apply skills only once a year; harmful norms remain

					FGM at 4.50 and child labour at 4.33) to 1.0 out of 5.0				highly prevalent.
	Stories of change.	Facilitate transformative dialogues.	PM4.1:1 Local community actors (CSOs, community actors, and legal duty bearers) are collaborating to build/strengthen relevant (i.e. context and conflict sensitive) community-based child protection mechanisms	Community members / Peace Committees / EACHR rights staff	Increase to 5.0 out of 5.0 the collaboration rating among local community actors (CSOs, community actors, and legal duty bearers) in building context- and conflict-sensitive community-based child protection mechanisms by 2028, raising the baseline	3.50 / 5.0 (Moderate) – local actor collaboration (baseline); staff competency in Non-Violent Communication (NVC) 3.50/5.0 (Moderate), frequency of use in the field 2.25/5.0 (Low)	KII responses of Partner Organisation, Community Leaders and Duty bearers; Des Report Sections 3.1.5 and 3.3.3 (p.35)	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: Peace Committees and multi-stakeholder dialogue platforms already exist; partnership support from Cord Global for peacebuilding capacity-development. Constraining: a "Knowledge-Action Gap" - staff are trained in NVC/conflict analysis but field-application frequency remains very low (1.75-2.25/5.0).

						collaborati on score from 3.50 to 5.0 out of 5.0 and the perceived impact of CSO collaborati on from 2.75 to 5.0 out of 5.0				
	Peace committees implement child focused procedures for effective peace- building.	Planning and delivery of pilot project in Marsabit County.	Sensitiz ation through media. Facilitat e Multi- stakehol der dialogue forums with duty bearers.	IN4.1:2 Number of community- based CP structures started/supp orted by the program.	Communi ty membe rs / Peace Commit tees	Establish and support 100% of targeted communit y-based child protection structures (including Child Protection Committee s, Children Assemble s, and Nyumba Kumi units) across the five project counties	0 new peacebuildin g/child- protection structures started under this project to date (baseline, Jan 2026); Marsabit pilot project not yet launched; existing Peace Committees already operate informally	Planning documen tation for the pilot project in Marsabit County; Docume nt review	Baselin e benchm ark establis hed	Enabling: existing Peace Committee structures provide a foundation for the planned pilot. Constraining: pilot project delivery has not yet begun; resource and capacity gaps remain.

					by 2028, elevating local actor collaboration scores from 3.50 to 5.0 out of 5.0 .				
	Pilot project reports.		IN4.1:3 Number of communities where MSDs have been held.	Community members / Peace Committees	Conduct Multi-Stakeholder Dialogues (MSDs) across 100% of targeted communities in all five project counties by 2028, elevating multi-stakeholder dialogue engagement from an occasional baseline score of 3.00 to 5.0 out of 5.0	0 MSDs held under the Marsabit peacebuilding pilot to date (baseline; project not yet operational as of Jan 2026)	Pilot project reports (planned); Document review	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: county-level dialogue platforms already exist to extend into the pilot. Constraining: no pilot-specific MSDs held yet; overall MSD engagement baseline is only "occasional" (3.00/5.0).

	Peace committees adopt more inclusive structures for effective peace building.			PM4.1:3 local community actors (with support from CSOs) are advocating for child protection systems, and accessible child friendly services, holding duty bearers to account for their provision.	Community members / Peace Committees	Increase to 5.0 out of 5.0 the collaboration rating among local community actors (CSOs, community actors, and legal duty bearers) in building context- and conflict-sensitive community-based child protection mechanisms by 2028, raising the baseline collaboration score from 3.50 to 5.0 out of 5.0 and the perceived impact of	Capacity to hold duty-bearers to account (baseline) 3.5/5.0 (Moderate-High); state responsiveness to system weaknesses 2.50/5.0 (Low)	Survey - KII responses of Partner Organizations, duty bearers and Community Leaders	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: EACHRights' high institutional confidence in advocacy (4.0/5.0) supports accountability efforts. Constraining: low state responsiveness; informal "Kangaroo courts"/"Maslah" systems bypass formal accountability mechanisms.
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						CSO collaborati on from 2.75 to 5.0 out of 5.0 .				
Delivery of Pilot project in Marsabit County.			PM4.1:4 CSOs are building forums ,coalit ions and networks for collective action, advocacy, and learning regarding community based child protection systems	CSOs / Commu nity leaders (Marsa bit)	Increase to 5.0 out of 5.0 the capacity score of CSOs building forums, coalitions, and networks for collective action, advocacy, and learning by 2028, raising baseline coalition building from 3.25 to 5.0 out of 5.0 and the perceived impact of CSO	3.25 / 5.0 (Moderate) – CSOs building forums/coal itions (baseline); delivery of the Marsabit pilot project not yet commenced as of Jan 2026	Docume nt review, surveys (KIIs) of Partner Organisa tion and Commu nity Leaders	Baselin e benchm ark establis hed	Enabling: national/coun ty coalition membership (UPR Kenya Coalition, Technical Working Groups) provides a platform to extend into the Marsabit pilot. Constraining: resource constraints and weak inter-sectoral coordination limit forum effectiveness.	

					collaboration from 2.75 to 5.0 out of 5.0 .				
			IN4.1:4 Number of learning studies on good practice models created by the networks.	CSOs / Partner organisation	Publish and disseminate learning studies on good practice models created by CSO networks across all five project counties by 2028, raising the perceived impact of CSO collaboration from 2.75 to 5.0 out of 5.0	0 learning studies on peacebuilding good-practice models created to date (baseline, Jan 2026)	Document review, surveys (KIIs) of Partner Organisation and Community Leaders	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: existing CSO coalitions offer a channel for future peacebuilding learning studies. Constraining: no studies produced yet; limited resources for structured peer learning.

				PM4.2:1 Duty bearers (working with local communities and CSOs) recognize/acknowledge shortcomings in the provision of children's legal right to protection (i.e. where they are failing in their legal responsibilities)	Duty bearers	Increase to 5.0 out of 5.0 the extent to which duty bearers (working with local communities and CSOs) recognize and acknowledge shortcomings in fulfilling children's legal right to protection by 2028, raising the baseline acknowledgment score from 3.00 (where 50% of respondents perceive very little responsibility) to 5.0	3.00 / 5.0 (Moderate) – duty-bearers acknowledging shortcomings (baseline finding, applied to the peacebuilding context)	Survey (KIIs) - Partner Organisation and Duty bearers	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: duty-bearers acknowledge the clarity of their legal responsibilities . Constraining: enforcement is weakened by personnel shortages and reliance on informal justice mechanisms.
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					out of 5.0 and state responsive ness from 2.50 to 5.0 out of 5.0 .				
			IN4.2:1 Number of Legal duty bearers reached with awareness/tr aining regarding child protection and community-based child protection approaches.	Legal duty bearers	Reach 100% of targeted legal duty-bearers (including children's officers, law enforceme nt, judicial officers, and local administra tors) across all five project counties with child protection and communit y-based child protection training by 2028, raising	0 legal duty bearers reached with peacebuildin g-specific awareness/t raining to date (baseline, Jan 2026)	Survey (KIIs) - Partner Organisa tion and Duty bearers	Baselin e benchm ark establis hed	Enabling: existing legal frameworks (Children Act 2022) provide grounding for future training. Constraining: no peacebuilding-specific duty-bearer training has been delivered yet.

					perceived state responsiveness from a baseline score of 2.50 to 5.0 out of 5.0				
			PM4.2:2 Legal duty-bearers commit to and implement policy changes to ensure laws - and guidelines/procedures to implement the laws - protect children and ensure the provision of children's rights.	Legal duty bearers	Ensure 100% of targeted legal duty-bearers commit to and implement child protection policy changes by 2028, finalizing pending draft county policies (such as the Garissa Gender and Anti-FGM policies) and securing dedicated budget	Government prioritization of child protection (incl. peacebuilding) 3.25/5.0 (Moderate); adequacy of national child protection policies 2.75/5.0 (Low-Moderate)	Survey (KIIs) - Partner Organisation and Duty bearers	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: mature national legal framework provides grounding for peacebuilding-related policy commitments. Constraining: implementation gap at county level; limited dedicated budget for peacebuilding-related policy action.

					lines for existing frameworks like the Marsabit Integrated Child Policy . This will elevate the perceived adequacy of national child protection policies from a baseline score of 2.75 to 5.0 out of 5.0, authorities addressing system weaknesses from 2.50 to 5.0 out of 5.0, and government prioritization of child protection from 3.25 to 5.0 out				
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						of 5.0				
		No. of Climate change committees and CSO networks trained on Climate adaptation and mitigation.	Building capacities for CSO networks and Climate Change committees on climate change adaptation and mitigation	IN2.1:1 Number of children supported (trained, coached, etc.) to act as agents of change on child rights	CSO networks / Climate Change committees	Support, train, and coach at least 1,120 child representatives (maintaining a 50:50 ratio of boys and girls) across 10 Children Assemblies in Garissa and Marsabit Counties by 2028, elevating the support/coaching score from a baseline of 4.40 to	0 Climate Change committees/ CSO networks trained on climate adaptation and mitigation to date under this project (baseline, Jan 2026); EACHRights staff technical confidence in child-climate impact analysis is low-moderate at 2.50/5.0	Document review; KII with EACHRights staff; Des Report Sections 3.1.6 and 3.3.4 (p.38)	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: EACHRights has an established Environment and Climate Justice programme and strong confidence integrating gender-equality/"Do No Harm" principles (3.5-3.75/5.0). Constraining: 75% of staff report very little confidence in technical child-climate impact analysis; geographic remoteness and poor infrastructure

					5.0 out of 5.0 and raising children's leadership confidence from 4.10 to 5.0 out of 5.0 .				in ASAL areas restrict delivery.	
	Local communities including CSO networks and Climate Change committees have knowledge to identify, adapt to or reduce disaster risk, environmental and climate degradation		Advocacy campaigns on climate adaptation and mitigation	PM2.1:3 Children are leading/initiating community development activities.	Local communities / CSO networks / Climate Change committees / children and youth	Increase to 100% the proportion of children leading or initiating community development activities across the target counties by 2028, raising the baseline rate from 90% to 100%, elevating children's confidence to lead from 4.1 to 5.0 out of 5.0, and	Baseline confidence: conflict-sensitivity in environmental assessments 3.25/5.0 (Moderate); technical child-climate impact analysis 2.50/5.0 (Low-Moderate); children in FGDs identified climate-related concerns as a pressing issue	KII/FGD with children and youth; Des Report Section 3.1.6 (p.38); Document review	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: solid staff understanding of "Do No Harm" and gender-equality principles in environmental work (3.5-3.75/5.0); children already raising climate concerns through Children Assemblies. Constraining: recurrent droughts/environmental degradation drive negative coping strategies (e.g. child marriage,

					improving duty-bearers' listening and support score from 3.4 to 5.0 out of 5.0 .				child labour); technical capacity for child-climate impact analysis remains low.
	No. of Climate change committees and CSO networks engaging in interventions to reduce disaster risk management, environmental and climate degradation		PM4.2:2 Legal duty-bearers commit to and implement policy changes to ensure laws - and guidelines/procedures to implement the laws - protect children and ensure the provision of children's rights.	CSO networks / Climate Change committees / Legal duty bearers	Ensure 100% of targeted legal duty-bearers commit to and implement child protection policy changes by 2028, finalizing pending draft county policies (such as the Garissa Gender and Anti-FGM policies)and securing dedicated	0 Climate Change committees/ CSO networks engaged in disaster-risk-reduction interventions to date under this project (baseline); related government policy prioritization stands at 3.25/5.0 (Moderate)	Document review; Des Report Sections 3.1.6 and 3.3.4 (p.38)	Baseline benchmark established	Enabling: existing Environment and Climate Justice programme and county-level Technical Working Groups provide entry points for future interventions. Constraining: limited financial/technical capacity among local community groups; poor ASAL infrastructure limits sustained environmental initiatives.

					budget lines for existing frameworks like the Marsabit Integrated Child Policy. This will elevate the perceived adequacy of national child protection policies from a baseline score of 2.75 to 5.0 out of 5.0; authorities addressing system weaknesses from 2.50 to 5.0 out of 5.0, and government prioritization of child protection from 3.25 to 5.0 out				
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